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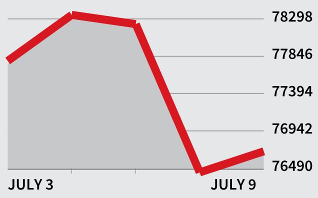
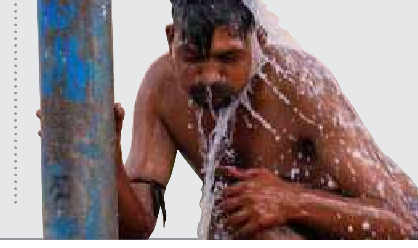


IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23962.80	+80.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.83	+0.07
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.38	-0.18
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	143081.00	+1301
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	223794.00	+2244



TOO HOT TO HANDLE. **June was the second** warmest on record, with ocean temperatures at an all-time high, according to C3S **p8**

UNDER THE LENS. **Govt awaiting** Meta's reply over child sexual exploitative materials in paid ads on Instagram **p3**

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QUICKLY.

RAISING FUNDS

SBI MF IPO priced at ₹545-574 per share

Mumbai: SBI Funds Management, the country's largest mutual fund house, has priced its initial public offering at ₹545-₹574 per equity share of face value ₹1 each. The promoters of the fund house, SBI and European fund management company Amundi India Holdings, will offload 12.83 crore shares and 7.54 crore shares to collectively raise ₹11,692 crore. The retail subscription will open on July 14. **p6**

RESHAPING LANDSCAPE

SFBs seek level playing field in co-lending market

Mumbai: Small finance banks (SFBs) are making a fresh push for being allowed to participate in co-lending arrangements with banks and NBFCs so that they can rebalance their loan portfolio amid the RBI relaxing priority sector lending target for them. **p7**

TCS holds steady as net profit rises 4.7% in Q1

MIXED BAG. Margins narrow on wage hikes, while AI revenue run-rate climbs to $2.6 b

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Scorecard

TCS	Q1FY26	Q4FY26	Q1FY27
Revenue (₹ cr)	63,437	70,698	72,275
PAT (₹ cr)	12,819	13,784	13,420
Headcount	6,13,069	5,84,519	5,93,798
Attrition (%)	13.8	13.7	13.6
TCV ($ bn)	9.4	12.0	9.5

including exceptional items

The net profit of Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) grew 4.7 per cent to ₹13,420 crore for the first quarter of FY27, led by positive annual growth across most verticals and AI transformation-focused deals.

Net profit declined 2.6 per cent on a sequential basis, owing to exceptional costs like the settlement of a legal claim. Excluding exceptional items, profit came in at ₹13,849 crore.

"Q1 FY27 reflects continued growth momentum and the strength of our strategic positioning despite geopolitical and macroeconomic headwinds. We delivered a strong order book of $9.5 billion, including a marquee AI-led transformation deal with SKF, while continuing to add clients across key revenue bands and scaling our AI business to a $2.6 billion annualised revenue run rate. As customers accelerate investments in AI, modernisation, cybersecurity, sovereign cloud and platform simplification, our strong deal conversion, improving client mining and expanding ecosystem partnerships position TCS well to translate opportunity into sustained growth," said K Krithivasan, CEO and MD.

AI REVENUE

Revenue grew 14 per cent to ₹72,275 crore annually and 2.2 per cent on a quarterly basis, led by growth across most segments.

Annualised AI revenue run rate stood at $2.6 billion, a sequential increase of 13.6 per cent. The first quarter usually remains muted for IT companies as part of a cyclical trend. The Board of Directors also declared an interim dividend of ₹12 per equity share of ₹1 each.

Total contract value fell by 20 per cent to $9.5 billion, winning three mega deals in Q1, including the SKF deal worth over $800 million. The operating margin declined to 24 per cent, down 130 bps owing to wage hikes.

"Q1 was characterised by strong growth across several services. We now multiple AI-led services, which are validating with our dual commitment to AI-led optimisation as well as innovation-led outcomes. These wins validate our approach to AI-led efficient IT operations, accelerated software engineering and modernisation, AI-first process redesign and implementation of SaaS solutions and autonomous GBS. We signed strategic partnerships with Anthropic and Mistral expanding our AI ecosystem," said Aarthi Subramanian, Executive Director, President and Chief Operating Officer.

Overall, TCS performed marginally better than expectations, according to Sandeep Shah, Director, Equity Research at Equirus Securities.

UPTICK IN WORKFORCE

The workforce grew by 9,729 employees to 5,93,798, a sequential growth rate of 1.58 per cent after multiple additions in the last financial year. The sequential growth is also the highest addition in the last 15 quarters, said Shah.

TCS reported a voluntary LTM attrition of 13.6 per cent. It focused on domain-specific and AI-native talent for lateral hires, with over 50 per cent already possessing next-generation skills, said Sudeep Kunnumal, Chief HR Officer.

See also p2

Iran sanctions rollback unlikely to disrupt India's crude supplies

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The rollback of the 60-day sanctions reprieve for Iran is unlikely to impact India's crude oil imports in August and September, with Russia, the US, West Africa and South America providing alternatives to the lost barrels from the Gulf.

However, trade sources and refiners indicated that liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) could again become a pain point if renewed hostilities continue for long, which would extend the closure of the Strait of Hormuz (SoH), impacting the supply of the key cooking medium for more than 33.50 crore Indian households.

'CAUTIOUS REVIEW ON'

"Refiners are cautiously reviewing the situation and awaiting clarity from the Foreign Ministry. Crude oil imports from Iran will get stuck after the US pulled back the sanctions waiver. We will see more dark tanker activity. Besides, the plan [import from Iran] is more of long term," said an executive with a domestic refiner.

Kpler said the recent exchange of fire in West Asia following President Donald Trump's comments on ceasefire had once again raised concerns over the security of the SoH.

"Crude flows through the Strait had not fully recovered before the latest escalation. For India, however, it has largely been business as usual over the past 100 days, with refiners successfully managing supply through a diversified import portfolio," the global real time data and analytics provider added.

Sumit Ritolia, Kpler's Lead Research Analyst for Refining and Modeling, told *businessline*: "Where I believe the market should pay closer attention is LPG and LNG. Unlike crude, these markets have fewer short-term substitution options, and remain more exposed to Gulf supply and shipping disruptions. A prolonged period of instability could tighten availability, increase freight costs and add pressure to regional prices again as we have seen over last few months."

RESILIENT PATH

Ritolia emphasised that India's crude import basket today is far more resilient than it was a few years ago. For instance, Russian crude continues to anchor a significant share of imports, while barrels from Saudi Arabia and the UAE are delivered via bypass infrastructure that provides an additional layer of supply security.

"West African and Latin American grades continue to supplement refinery requirements. Cargoes that can safely transit the Strait are still expected to move, although freight rates and insurance costs could rise if tensions persist," he said.

For now, Ritolia explained that India's crude supply story remains one of diversification and resilience, not immediate scarcity.

US cracks down on alleged misuse of H-1B visas, Cognizant comes under scrutiny

Rohan Das
Chennai

The Trump administration has reignited concerns over H-1B visas, with the US Department of Labor launching an investigation against the alleged misuse of the employment visa, alongside labour trafficking and other fraudulent labour practices.

As officials announced the probe, US-headquartered IT services firm Cognizant, which has a majority of its employees in India, was also named among the companies under scrutiny.

"Today, we launched a massive H-1B fraud investigation. @POTUS promised the Golden Age of the American Worker — and he's delivering. Foreign labour fraud steals jobs from Americans, enables human trafficking, creates dangerous worksites and threatens public safety. No more," Anthony D'Esposito, Inspector General, US Department of Labor, announced in a social media post.

NOTICES ISSUED

In an interview with a US television channel, D'Esposito said the government had issued notices to multiple companies which, he alleged, were misusing the H-1B programme. "We have already issued dozens of subpoenas and will track down every lead," he said.

D'Esposito mentioned that the government had received intel from whistleblowers about companies, including IT major Cognizant.

Cognizant did not respond to *businessline*'s query regarding the developments.

"American jobs ought to go to American workers and not foreign fraudsters, and the Department of Labor is fighting back against it," said US Vice-President JD Vance on Wednesday at an event in Milwaukee.

The US government had previously tried to make the H-1B visa regime more stringent when President Donald Trump signed an order imposing a one-time $1,00,000 fee for new petitions. However, a federal judge struck down the requirement last month.

Indians have historically been among the largest beneficiaries of H-1B visas. The industry that relies heavily on H-1B visas is technology, which accounts for roughly 60 to 70 per cent of all the new applications in recent years. Other top industries include consulting and professional services, engineering and manufacturing, healthcare and medical research and higher education.

DECLINE IN APPROVALS

Data show that IT service majors such as Infosys, TCS and Cognizant, alongside US big tech companies that include Amazon, Meta and others, are the major users of the employment visa.

The US administration's decision to launch an investigation comes at a time when there has been a decline in H-1B approvals.

According to data from HR services firm Xpheno, 52,360 new H-1B visas were approved in FY26 (YTD) against 1,13,485 in 2025 and 1,39,692 in 2024.

Vikram Solar in ₹15,037 crore deal with TN

Our Bureau
Chennai

Kolkata-based Vikram Solar has signed an MoU with the Government of Tamil Nadu to set up a manufacturing plant for battery energy storage systems in the State. Under the MoU, the company will invest ₹15,037 crore to set up the facility at SIPCOT Gangaikondan Industrial Park in Tirunelveli district. The project is expected to create jobs for 2,670 people, according to a government statement.

The MoU was signed in the presence of Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay and Gyanesh Chaudhary, CMD of Vikram Solar Ltd, alongside other company executives and government officials.

Details on p2

AUSTRALIA BECKONS

BOLSTERING TIES. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese being welcomed at an Indian community event in Melbourne on Thursday. Modi said he was delighted that the partnership between the countries in the areas of education, skills and innovation is deepening and strengthening **(Reports on Page 3)** PTI

Monsoon covers the entire country with 38% excess rain between July 1 and 9

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

WHEN IT RAINS IT POURS. A truck remains stuck after a road caved in due to heavy rainfall in New Delhi on Thursday ANI

The South-West monsoon covered the entire country on July 9, despite its onset being delayed by a day from its normal schedule. The monsoon's coverage date in the last four years was earlier than normal.

Amid forecasts of a super El Nino, the timely arrival of the monsoon in all parts of the North-West region and 38 per cent surplus rain in the first nine days this month may help boost kharif sowing, which took a hit on account of 37 per cent deficit rainfall in June.

"The South-West monsoon has further advanced into the remaining parts of the north Arabian Sea, Rajasthan, Haryana and Punjab. Thus, it has covered the entire country on July 9 against the normal date of July 8," the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said. Monsoon set in over Kerala on June 4, delayed by three days from its normal date, though the IMD had predicted early arrival on May 26.

DELAYED ONSET

The monsoon has covered the entire country in June only six times since 2000; the earliest was on June 16 in 2013, when the seasonal rainfall for the entire year was 106 per cent of normal.

The IMD has predicted this year's monsoon to be 90 per cent of normal (or 10 per cent deficit) in the June-September season.

According to IMD data, the country as a whole received 204.7 mm rainfall between June 1 and July 9, which is 14 per cent below the long period average (LPA) of 239.1 mm. The east and north-east meteorological subdivision received 38 per cent deficit rainfall, while in the north-west subdivision, it was 9 per cent below normal. In central India, it was 3 per cent surplus and 15 per cent below normal rainfall in the June 1-July 9 period in the southern peninsula. Only 13 States and Union Territories are deficient, including Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, Bihar, Kerala and Assam.

With more information flowing in, the actual rainfall in the June 1-30 period was revised to 37 per cent below normal after the IMD reported it initially at a 40 per cent deficit.

Overall acreage under kharif crops is down 21 per cent to 350.85 lakh hectares (lh) as on July 5 from 442.80 lh a year ago. Total live storage in 166 important reservoirs in different parts of the country, monitored by the Central Water Commission as on July 9, is 59.443 BCM. The current year's storage is nearly 63.52 per cent of last year's storage and 107.62 per cent of the normal.

DRL's semaglutide supply hits stumbling block, spills over to other companies too

PT Jyothi Datta
G Naga Sridhar
Mumbai/Hyderabad

Generic supplies of semaglutide from Dr Reddy's Laboratories have hit a stumbling block, creating a domino effect across other companies, including Torrent Pharmaceuticals and USV.

"Certain batches of semaglutide were found to be out of specification due to an issue associated with the active pharmaceutical ingredient (API) used in the product. We are investigating the root cause and taking appropriate measures to ensure product quality. Until the issue is resolved, commercial supplies of the product will be delayed for a certain period of time," said DRL, adding that patient safety was not impacted nor were the product's existing global regulatory filings.

The company's management told analysts that there was a process-linked issue during scaling up, affecting future supplies in the country and Canada.

DRL Chief Executive Officer Erez Israeli was optimistic that supplies could resume by October/November. The company would be able to supply 6-7 million pens by the second half of the year, he added.

Vishal Manchanda, Senior Vice-President (Institutional Research), Systematix Group, told *businessline* that the longer the company takes, the more it would be impacted. The early mover advantage is important in any market, he said, adding that the supply disruption now affects this start.

DRL was one of the several drugmakers that launched its version of the product after semaglutide lost its patent protection in March.

Semaglutide is the active ingredient in Novo Nordisk's weightloss drug Wegovy and diabetes product Ozempic.

Diabetologist V Mohan said patients taking semaglutide from any of these companies could move to similar products.

VOLUNTARY RECALL

In its update, Torrent Pharmaceuticals said it was implementing a voluntary recall as a "precautionary measure" for select batches of Semalix injection disposable pens.

"This action follows a product recall notification issued by our manufacturer Dr Reddy's Laboratories Ltd, Hyderabad, for a technical evaluation," it said.

Reiterating that there was no risk to patients on this treatment, the company said other formats of semaglutide from Torrent, including the oral formulation, were unaffected.

The company listed the affected products, including Semalix injection (select batches of 2 mg and 4 mg manufactured by DRL).

It also listed its unaffected products, including Semalix tablet 3 mg, 7 mg and 4 mg (that are manufactured by Torrent); Sembolic tablet 3 mg, 7 mg and 14 mg (Torrent); Semalix injection 8 mg (from MSN Laboratories); and Sembolic re-usable injection (from Zydus Lifesciences).

USV did not respond to queries from *businessline* at the time of going to press.

QUICKLY.

Havells inks BESS pact with Norway's Pixii AS

New Delhi: Havells India said it has entered into a strategic collaboration with Pixii AS, a Norway-based energy storage technology company, to develop and introduce advanced battery energy storage systems (BESS) for the Indian market. This marks the company's entry into the BESS segment. As part of the strategic collaboration, the companies will work through a phased roadmap to establish a long-term BESS ecosystem in India. OUR BUREAU

Power Grid secures JBIC loan for HVDC

New Delhi: State-run Power Grid Corporation of India has secured a green loan of JPY 80 billion (about ₹4,700 crore) from Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) for financing of the Khavda-Nagpur HVDC transmission project. The financed project involves transmitting electricity from the Khavda Renewable Energy Park in Gujarat to Nagpur in Maharashtra, highlighting the strategic collaboration between Power Grid and JBIC to develop critical infrastructure for renewable energy integration. OUR BUREAU

Nissan bets on India revival with Tekton, maps EV entry by 2028

GRAND PLAN. To expand domestic line-up from one locally-manufactured model to four

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Nissan Motor India on Thursday launched the all-new Tekton mid-size SUV at an introductory price of ₹10.49 lakh (ex-showroom), using the launch to outline a broader revival strategy that includes expanding its locally-manufactured portfolio to four models and entering the country's electric vehicle (EV) market by around 2028.

For Nissan, which holds about 0.6-0.7 per cent of India's passenger vehicle market, the Tekton is intended to become a second volume pillar alongside the Magnite, as it rebuilds its presence in one of the world's fastest-growing automotive markets.

"We are building a stronger and more competitive Nissan in India," said Guillaume Cartier, Chief Performance Officer, Nissan.

The Japanese automaker said it is evaluating multiple pathways for its India EV programme, including local manufacturing, imports and technology partnerships, as it prepares for the industry's transition to the tighter CAFE-III norms.

MARKET AVAILABILITY. Bookings for the Tekton opened on Thursday, ahead of deliveries beginning on July 20 PTI

Bookings for the Tekton opened on Thursday, ahead of deliveries beginning on July 20. Built on the Renault-Nissan Alliance's CMF-B platform, the five-seater SUV marks Nissan's return to India's mid-size SUV segment and will compete with rivals such as the Hyundai Creta, Kia Seltos and Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara.

BUILDING SCALE

The company plans to expand its domestic line-up from one locally-manufactured model to four.

The Tekton will be produced at the Renault-Nissan Alliance plant in Chennai under Nissan's "One Car, One World" philosophy and exported to West Asia and Africa. The company said localisation will increase as the supplier ecosystem matures, strengthening the country's role as both a manufacturing and export hub.

EV ROADMAP

Alongside its product expansion, Nissan offered its clearest indication yet of its India electrification strategy. It is assessing whether future EVs should be manufactured locally, introduced through partnerships or brought in as imports, with the final approach depending on customer demand, charging infrastructure, government policy, battery sourcing and commercial viability.

"We can partner, we can manufacture, and we can bring one," company officials said, outlining the options under evaluation and adding that electrification would be pursued when there is a sustainable business case rather than solely to meet regulatory requirements. Nissan expects to introduce an EV in India around 2028.

HONDA OPTION

Company officials said project-level collaboration with Honda remains one of the technology options under evaluation globally, with discussions continuing around software-defined vehicles, ECUs and next-generation EV technologies. While India forms part of those discussions, no decision had been taken on deploying any such collaboration in the country.

Experts say the timeline could allow the Renault-Nissan Alliance to leverage the investments made in its CMF-B architecture before introducing an affordable EV. One potential pathway is the AmpR Small platform, which shares around half its components with CMF-B, enabling higher localisation, lower investment and greater supplier commonality if selected for India.

The growing importance of debt funding for Indian start-ups

Thillai Rajan A

Fund raising is a key priority for founders since it takes several years for start-ups to become cash positive or generate profits and access external capital. Given their risk profile, equity is the primary source of funding. But the number of start-ups funded by debt has increased by more than 15 times between 2016 and 2024. In years when VC funding dries up, as seen in 2023 and 2024, debt appears to be acting as a backstop.

DATA FOCUS.

Start-ups access equity funds from angel investors and VC funds. The number of start-ups receiving their first angel funding during the year has shown a decreasing trend during 2016-25. The median round values have, however, shown an increasing trend during the same period.

The median age of the start-up when it receives the first angel funding has also been increasing over the years, while the number of start-ups that receive their first angel funding within the first year of incorporation has been reducing.

The number of start-ups that received VC funding during the year has shown a slightly increasing trend during 2016-25, though not significantly. The trends in median round values, the median age of the start-up when it receives the first VC funding, the number of start-ups that receive their first VC funding within the first year of incorporation has been similar to that of the trends in angel funding. Though the time taken to receive the first round of angel funding is not very different from that of VC funding, the VC funding rounds are about 6.8 times larger than that of an angel round.

DEBT FUNDING TRENDS

The surprise element in the package has been debt funding. While banks and other FIs are usually not perceived as a significant source of start-up funding, the on-ground reality is very different. Contrary to the trends seen in angel and VC funding, though the average debt funding round has not significantly increased, the number of start-ups that have received debt funding has increased by more than 15 times between 2016 and 2024.

Private commercial banks have supported the most number of start-ups, whereas private NBFCs have invested the most capital. An interesting aspect was the support extended by public sector banks, known for their conservative approach to risk. Public sector banks have invested in more than 18,000 start-ups.

IMPLICATIONS

The number of start-ups funded by angels and VCs have not seen comparable growth to the number of start-ups formed. Founders have to come to terms with this ground reality and tailor their fund-raising strategies.

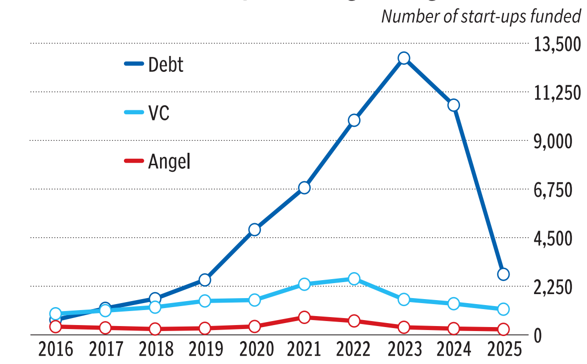
On average, start-ups are taking more time to get their first round of angel or VC funding. Founders have to, therefore, bring in more capital through their own sources, family or friends to sustain the operations during the initial uncertain period.

Though VCs form the largest source of capital for start-up funding (about 64 per cent of the total), debt funding from banks and FIs contribute around 30 per cent. Founders may, therefore, consider including their friendly banker in the list of prospective investors.

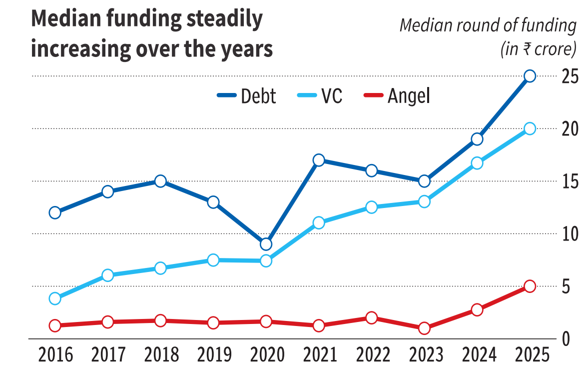
The writer is Professor, IIT-Madras, and Head, Centre for Research on Start-ups and Risk Financing, and Founder, YNOS Venture Engine. Research inputs from Dr Vamanie Perumal and Chinni Chaitanya

Trends in start-up funding

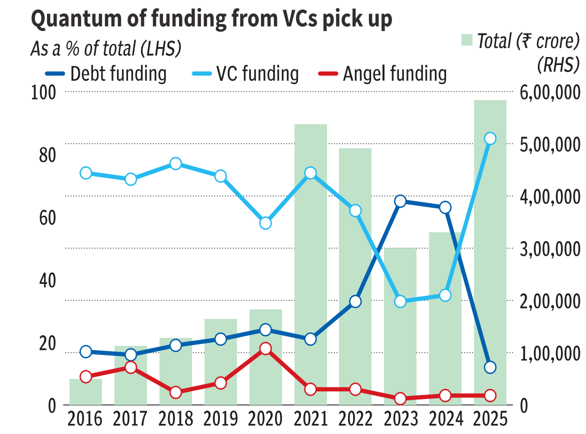
The number of start-ups receiving funding falls in 2025



Median funding steadily increasing over the years



Quantum of funding from VCs pick up



NBFCs dominate in share of debt providers to start-ups

For the 10-year period 2016-25

Type of financial institution	Total investment (₹ crore)	Total start-ups	Average investment per start-up (₹ crore)
Private commercial banks	2,80,725	24,240	12
Public commercial banks	1,76,178	18,340	10
Private NBFC	3,42,632	7,468	46
Rural and co-operative banks	5,096	1,658	3
Foreign banks	33,702	1,047	32
Others	35,943	1,250	29

Source: YNOS Venture Engine

We target doubling India sales, says Thierry Sabbagh

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Nissan will launch its seven-seat C-SUV by the first quarter of 2027 as part of a four-product offensive aimed at rebuilding its presence in India. The Japanese automaker is targeting a doubling of domestic sales as its product portfolio expands, while also growing exports from India.

Thierry Sabbagh, Divisional Vice-President and President - Middle East, KSA and India, Nissan Group AMIEO, discusses India's role in Nissan's global plans, premium SUVs, future technologies and the company's growth strategy.

Edited excerpts:

> We are fully aligned with current regulations, including E20 requirements, and will continue adapting
>
> **THIERRY SABBAGH**
> Divisional Vice-President and President - Middle East, KSA and India, Nissan Group AMIEO

You have successfully led Nissan's growth across West Asia. Why has Nissan decided to significantly step up its commitment in India?

India is one of the most exciting automotive markets in the world and already the third-largest globally. Nissan has made a clear decision to stay and grow here. The Magnite, launched in 2021, helped us reconnect with Indian customers and better understand their expectations. Our strategy today is simple — India for India and India to the World. We are preparing to launch four products across key segments, while strengthening India's role as a manufacturing and export hub.

Does India's rapidly-expanding premium SUV market create a business case for Nissan to introduce flagship models such as the Patrol?

India is becoming an increasingly attractive premium market, and Nissan has a strong global portfolio. The Patrol is one of our flagship products with a strong reputation, particularly in West Asia. We are studying opportunities for premium products in India and evaluating different routes to market.

India has emerged as an important export base for Nissan, while domestic volumes are also gaining momentum. How do you balance the two?

We do not view exports and domestic sales as competing priorities. They are two separate growth engines. Our objective is to grow both. If we can double exports while also doubling or tripling domestic volumes, that is the ideal outcome. The same product platforms can serve both businesses, with specifications adapted for different markets. At the same time, we are expanding our dealer network and strengthening our presence.

How is Nissan using technology to improve customer experience?

Customer expectations are increasingly going digital. We are investing in digital platforms and introducing an AI-powered vehicle configurator that allows customers to explore products, compare variants, obtain information and schedule test-drives.

Nissan has global strengths in electrification and e-power hybrid technology. How do you see India's powertrain mix evolving?

Every market evolves differently, and powertrain choices depend on customer demand, regulations and commercial viability. Nissan has extensive experience in electrification and hybrid technologies globally. In India, our current focus remains on internal combustion engine vehicles, but we continue evaluating hybrids and other technologies with our teams in Japan and India.

India is rapidly tightening emission norms while pushing ethanol blending and flex-fuel vehicles. How prepared is Nissan?

We are fully aligned with current regulations, including E20 requirements, and will continue adapting as regulations evolve. Nissan also has global expertise in flex-fuel technologies.

The global auto industry continues to navigate geopolitical uncertainty and supply-chain disruptions. Does that affect Nissan's plans for India?

The industry has experienced various disruptions in recent years, but our focus remains on long-term strategy. Our plans for India remain unchanged. We have a clear growth roadmap and will continue executing it while adapting to changing conditions when required.

Macro uncertainty weighs on TCS across geographies, biz verticals

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) reported mixed market and vertical performance during Q1 of FY27, owing to macroeconomic and geopolitical headwinds. All vertical segments of TCS, aside from the consumer business, showed positive annual growth. Among the verticals, Energy, Resources and Utilities, and Life Sciences led growth on a year-on-year basis. However, on a sequential basis, the energy, life sciences and manufacturing verticals declined between 0.5 per cent and 4 per cent.

While BFSI performance was muted compared to the previous quarter, when it led growth, K. Krithivasan, CEO and Managing Director, TCS, said banks continue to do well in the current global environment and voiced confidence in the segment's growth. The manufacturing segment suffered a hit as the auto business, which is a significant part of the segment, was affected by tariff pressure, macro uncertainty, EV recalibration, supply-chain resilience and cost pressures. However, the management expects manufacturing growth to turn around in the coming quarter, considering core demand for AI transformation, automation and compliance initiatives.

"Tech, software and services continued to maintain growth momentum. We successfully won several large- and mid-sized deals in this segment, including a multi-million dollar deal with ServiceNow," he said. However for the consumer business or retail, the management flagged a combination of inflationary pressures and ongoing geopolitical uncertainties are impacting discretionary spend.

"In this environment, client priorities have been focused on managing their increasing costs. Growth initiatives remained selective, centred on targeted areas that could deliver scalable impact without increasing risk exposure," said Krithivasan, adding that retail will return with improved sentiment around geopolitics conditions.

NO DISRUPTION

TCS' market performance faced no disruption owing to global developments beyond travel and transport restrictions last year, he said, but spoke of potential impact in case of supply-chain disruption.

In terms of geography, the Indian market reported a 22.9 per cent year-on-year growth and a 7.6 per cent sequential growth. Latin America declined 2.1 per cent annually, but grew 0.6 per cent sequentially. Meanwhile, the UK market fell 0.6 per cent annually and grew 0.3 per cent sequentially. West Asia and Africa grew 7.6 per cent annually, but declined 1.8 per cent sequentially. Regional markets fell by 0.6 per cent annually and grew 1.2 per cent sequentially.

"In the US, corporate revenue growth seems to be quite decent. Consensus expectations for this year on growth, overall, is y broad-based across industries and seems strong," he said.

Vikram Solar signs MoU for ₹15,037-crore BESS plant in Tamil Nadu

Our Bureau
Chennai

Kolkata-based Vikram Solar has signed an MoU with the Government of Tamil Nadu to set up a battery energy storage systems (BESS) manufacturing plant in the State. Under the MoU, the company will invest ₹15,037 crore to set up the facility at the SIPCOT Gangaikondan Industrial Park in Tirunelveli district.

The project is expected to create job opportunities for 2,670 people, according to a government statement.

The MoU was signed on Thursday in the presence of Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay and Gyanesh Chaudhary, Chairman and Managing Director of Vikram Solar, alongside company executives and government officials.

businessline could not independently ascertain the timeline for the proposed investment and queries to the company at the time of going to press remained unanswered.

> **The BESS plant is expected to create** job opportunities for 2,670 people

TN PRESENCE

Vikram Solar already operates in Tamil Nadu, and is in the process of constructing multiple facilities in the State.

The plans include module manufacturing facilities at Vallam and Oragadam in Kancheepuram district, and an integrated solar module and cell manufacturing park at Gangaikondan in Tirunelveli district.

The company rolled out the first module made at the Gangaikondan plant earlier this week.

The BESS plant in Gangaikondan is part of Vikram Solar's target of 15 gigawatt-hours of BESS capacity by FY30.

GROWTH FRONTIER

"Battery energy storage will be the next major growth frontier for Vikram Solar. It is a business that is policy-anchored, margin-accretive, and the piece that converts intermittent solar into dispatchable power," Chaudhary mentioned in a recent earnings call.

PepsiCo's India business boosts international beverage organic revenue growth in Q2 CY26

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

PepsiCo on Thursday said its India business witnessed strong volume growth across snacks and beverages, aiding the organic revenue growth of its international business during Q2 CY26.

The company, which released its global earnings said that the international organic revenue growth was up 7 per cent in the second quarter.

The company said its international beverage organic revenue growth was aided by markets including the UK, Brazil, Colombia, Argentina, Egypt, Türkiye, Germany, Poland, Saudi Arabia and India in the second quarter of 2026.

"Year-to-date, we held or gained savoury snack share in China, Brazil, India, Egypt... For beverages, we held or gained share in the UK, Philippines, Germany, Argentina, Australia, Spain, India, Thailand, Guatemala, Egypt and Vietnam," the company's senior management stated in prepared remarks.

On the performance of the Asia-Pacific Foods unit during Q2 CY26, the company in its regulatory disclosures said that unit volume grew 10 per cent, primarily reflecting growth in India.

On its performance of the International Beverages Franchise segment, the company added that unit volume grew 5 per cent in the quarter under review, primarily reflecting broad-based increases, led by India.

"Year-to-date, PepsiCo's global organic volume has increased at the highest rate since 2022 — aided by the strength of the international business and the continued evolution of the portfolio," said Ramon Laguarta, Chairman and CEO, PepsiCo, in a statement.

SHARPER FOCUS

PepsiCo India recently said that it is committed to invest ₹5,700 crore between 2025 and 2030.

This includes the addition of new foods manufacturing facilities in Assam and Tamil Nadu, alongside the recent commissioning of its state-of-the-art ₹1,266 crore flavour manufacturing plant in Ujjain, Madhya Pradesh.

JSW Steel output grows 3% in June quarter

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

JSW Steel on Thursday said its consolidated output increased 3 per cent year-on-year to 6.59 million tonnes (mt) in the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The company had produced 6.38 mt of crude steel in the April-June period of 2025-26, it said in an exchange filing.

The production number includes India and JSW Steel's operations in Ohio, US.

JSW Steel is among the top five steel-producing companies in India.

QUICKLY.

ADB trims India's FY27 growth projection to 6.6%

New Delhi: The Asian Development Bank on Thursday lowered India's GDP growth projection to 6.6 per cent as against 6.9 per cent estimated earlier for the current fiscal on concerns of higher energy prices fuelled by the West Asia crisis. Despite the growth moderation, India still continues to be the fastest-growing major economy in the world. GDP growth forecasts are revised down to 6.6 per cent for FY2026 (ending March 31, 2027) and maintained at 7.3 per cent for FY2027, the Asian Development Outlook July 2026 said. PTI

Quality control norms for footwear sector amended

New Delhi: The government has amended two quality control orders for the footwear sector, under which the timeline for the clearance of legacy stock has been extended by one year to July 31, 2027. The amendments were made in the Footwear made from Leather and other Materials (Quality Control) Order, 2024, and the Footwear made from All Rubber and all Polymeric Material and its Components (Quality Control) Order, 2024. "Under the amendments, the timeline for clearance of legacy stock has been extended from July 31, 2026 to July 31, 2027," the Commerce and Industry Ministry said. PTI

India, Australia agree on framework to streamline defence trade, services

DEEPENING TIES. Both nations ink reciprocal agreement for 'expanding aircraft deployments'

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Building upon the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (CSP) established in 2020, India and Australia on Thursday signed a broader policy framework — an 'MoU for the provision of defence articles and defence services,' designed to streamline and shape ways the two nations will buy, sell, share and maintain military equipment and specialised technical services.

This is part of a string of announcements at the Third India-Australia Annual Summit in Melbourne, led by Prime Ministers Narendra Modi and Anthony Albanese, with New Delhi appears to be looking to elevate its defence ties with Australia in some domains to match its engagements with other major developed nations. PM Modi is currently on a two-day official visit to Australia, which began on July 8.

STRATEGIC PARTNER. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Australian PM Anthony Albanese at the India-Australia Annual Summit in Melbourne on Thursday REUTERS

BILATERAL INNOVATION

Both the nations have decided to explore a bilateral innovation framework to connect respective ecosystems and accelerate collaboration among governments, industry, academia, and research institutions for promoting R&D based solutions for advanced capability solutions. The initiative reflects similar arrangements India has had with the US, France and South Korea.

The two Prime Ministers "welcomed the ongoing work to develop a memorandum of understanding for the provision of defence articles and defence services, and efforts to promote connections between Australian and Indian defence industries, including through Australia's first defence trade mission to India and the Australia-India Defence Industry Roundtable," read a joint statement issued after the Summit.

They have inked reciprocal agreement for 'expanding aircraft deployments from each other's territories' which India has formalised with other countries, like US, Russia, France, and Japan, for mutual support of military logistics to facilitate parking and refuelling, among others. In their commitment to the Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Co-operation and strengthening of the maritime security collaboration roadmap, the two countries aim at establishing a robust blueprint for regional stability and defence modernisation.

Reacting to the developments, Arun Ramchandani, President SIDM, told *businessline* that Modi's current visit to Australia had resulted in one of the most substantial upgrades in India–Australia strategic ties since the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

"The geopolitical dynamic security and economic uncertainties has steered nations world over to reboot and relook at their security and commercial strategies and policies. While the visit produced 18 agreements and initiatives, the defence and security outcomes are particularly significant from a maritime security and defence industry & start-up perspective," he said.

KEY AREAS

The two, as per the joint statement, have identified four areas for strengthening comprehensive defence co-operation, and deepening strategic dialogue. They are for: (a) undertaking to consult on defence-related developments in the Indo-Pacific that affect shared interests; (b) increasing the complexity of our defence exercises, including with partners; (c) accelerating efforts to build interoperability and information sharing between defence forces; and (d) expanding aircraft deployments from each other's territories.

Australia to send business delegation to India in Dec

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Australia will send a senior business delegation to India during Australia Week in December and convene a new investment roundtable in Mumbai as part of a renewed push to deepen economic engagement with one of the world's fastest-growing major economies, Prime Minister Anthony Albanese said.

The delegation will be led by the Business Council of Australia, while Austrade and the Australian High Commission in New Delhi will organise the Mumbai investment roundtable to encourage two-way investment.

INVESTMENT IN NIIF

"I welcome the announcement we have had this morning from AustralianSuper that they will invest an additional AU$500 million into India's National Investment and Infrastructure Fund. This is about building on and broadening out the four key priorities in our roadmap: clean energy, education and skills, agribusiness, and tourism. In every one of those sectors, new work to deepen our engagement is already underway," Albanese said at the Australia-India economic roadmap business reception on Thursday. AustralianSuper is the pension fund manager of Australia.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who is on an official visit to Australia as part of his three-nation tour, attended as the guest of honour. Addressing business leaders, Albanese said the relationship between the two countries had undergone a significant transformation over the past decade.

Calling the Indian diaspora the "living bridge" between the two countries, Albanese said India's emergence as the world's fastest-growing major economy and its trajectory to become the third-largest economy by the end of the decade presented enormous opportunities for Australian businesses.

He said Australia wanted its businesses, technology and expertise to contribute to India's growth.

EDUCATION TIES

Highlighting growing education ties, Albanese said that Australia now has approval for eight university branch campuses in India after Deakin University became the first foreign university to establish a campus in the country. He also welcomed Monash University's announcement of a $75 million investment to expand co-operation with India.

In agribusiness, Albanese cited Perdaman's Project Ceres urea manufacturing facility in Karratha as an example of successful collaboration. The project is expected to become Australia's largest urea plant with annual production of 2.3 mt.

India aspires to shape next-gen tech, products, enterprises: FM

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Thursday called for making global capability centre (GCC) to shape the enterprises of the future. She also highlighted that lot of opportunities are yet to be untapped.

"Our aspiration is not merely to host the world's capability centres, but to shape the next-generation technologies, products and enterprises of the future," she said at the GCC Business Summit, hosted by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII). According to her, that is how India moves from capability to leadership. It is also an important step towards building a Viksit Bharat that is prosperous, innovative, resilient and respected across the world.

Talking about the opportunities, she said around two-thirds of Fortune Global 2000 companies had yet to establish a GCC in India. This is one of the largest untapped investment opportunities before India. The ambition of building an ecosystem capable of supporting around 5,000 GCCs by 2030 is therefore both realistic and achievable. And this is a milestone on a much larger journey. "The next phase of this growth presents significant opportunities in newer geographies, including East and West Asia, Eastern Europe, the Nordic countries and Australasia," she said.

TAPPING POTENTIAL. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman at the inaugural session of CII GCC Business Summit 2026 PTI

She urged India Inc for greater engagement with the State governments and city administrations. "As GCCs expand into newer locations, such partnerships can help shape infrastructure, skills and institutional support in line with industry requirements," Sitharaman said, while adding that the engagements will help the policymakers appreciate the importance of GCCs.

GCC JOURNEY

She listed expectations for the next phase of the GCC journey. First, continue moving decisively up the value chain by creating intellectual property, lead frontier research, develop AI applications, own product architecture and drive global innovation. Second, deepen engagement with knowledge institutions by having stronger partnerships with universities, start-ups and centres of excellence to ensure that innovation moves seamlessly from laboratories to markets.

Third, expand confidently into emerging cities as tier-2 and tier-3 cities are rapidly developing the talent, infrastructure and innovation capacity required for globally competitive enterprises. In many emerging cities, the transformative economic impact that GCCs can have is still not widely understood.

"I would encourage every enterprise represented here to become an ambassador for India's capabilities. Enterprises that have invested successfully in India are our most credible ambassadors. Their success stories remain the strongest endorsement of India's GCC ecosystem," she said, mentioning this as the fourth expectation.

And, fifth, strengthening partnerships with governments by sharing practical feedback on policy, processes, talent and infrastructure so that a stronger GCC ecosystem for the future can be created. "India's GCC journey is much larger than the story of one successful sector. It is about making India indispensable to the world's knowledge economy and strengthening our long-term economic resilience," she said.

Highlighting the sector's growth, she said India is home to more than 2,100 GCCs, employing over 2.3 million professionals and generating annual revenues of about $100 billion.

Customs duty cut on key components for electronics to deepen value chain, ecosystem: MeitY's Krishnan

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The government's move to waive basic customs duty on key components for electronics manufacturing will help deepen the value chain and the ecosystem, S Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), said on Thursday.

Speaking on the sidelines of the CII GCC Business Summit, he said it was an "important change", and the move will also stimulate the electronics component industry in the country.

"Based on the industry representations, this is something that we had taken up with the Ministry of Finance. We are very happy that these notifications have been issued. This will really stimulate the electronics industry, especially the electronics component industry in the country," Krishnan said.

The Finance Ministry, through a notification, has exempted customs duty on specified goods used in the manufacture of lithium-ion cells, inductor coil modules and display assemblies.

EXPANDED LIST

Under the new notification, the government has expanded the list of machinery and equipment that can be imported without payment of customs duty for use in manufacturing lithium-ion cells.

The exemption also covers a wide range of specialised machines and systems used across the production process including powder

MANUFACTURING PUSH. S Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY, at the inaugural session of the CII GCC Business Summit 2026

dryers, automatic feeding and blending systems, slurry transfer systems, cathode and anode extrusion coating machines, compression equipment, high vacuum pumps, winding machines, electrode cutting and slitting machines, testing machines, auto-packing systems, etc.

The exemption list also includes welding machines, ultrasonic cleaning machines, electrolyte injection machines, solvent and heat recovery systems, cell baking and cooling machines, laser welding and notching equipment, cell formation and inspection systems, water sprinkler systems, racks and wire filling and welding machines.

The Finance Ministry also said the amendments have been made after the government was satisfied that such measures are necessary in the public interest. The duty exemptions are likely to lower production costs and strengthen India's manufacturing ecosystem for advanced batteries and electronic components.

According to Pankaj Mohindroo, Chairman, India Cellular & Electronics Association, the broad basing of the duty dispensation for display assembly to auto display, medical display and industrial displays is a huge step which will building the industry in these verticals like it has happened in mobiles and consumer electronics. "The exemption on important capital goods for lithium ion industry across all segments including electric vehicles and battery energy storage system will make the industry more competitive," he added.

Manoj Mishra, Partner and Tax Controversy Management Leader at Grant Thornton Bharat, said the Centre's decision to grant BCD exemptions on key inputs used in the manufacture of display assemblies, wireless charging modules and lithium-ion cells is another step towards strengthening India's electronics manufacturing ecosystem.

'Govt will await Meta's response on CSEAM issue'

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The government on Thursday said it will await Meta's formal reply to notice served last week over Child Sexual Exploitative and Abuse Material (CSEAM) in paid advertisements on Instagram, and a view be taken based on the response given by the company.

Speaking on the sidelines of CII GCC Business Summit, S Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY, said: "We will await the formal response to the notice that we have issued, and thereafter we will take a view based on what the response is."

MeitY Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw had directed officials to summon Meta over Instagram ads allegedly promoting child sexual abuse material. The Ministry demanded an explanation and information from the company on action that had been taken.

REGULATORY SCRUTINY

The regulatory scrutiny from the government came amid a *BBC* report which alleged that Meta's recommendation algorithm had been promoting videos containing child sexual abuse material, exposing serious gaps in the safeguard mechanisms.

The *BBC investigation* had also allegedly found advertisements of this nature appearing on Facebook and Instagram, despite Meta's advertising policies explicitly prohibiting nudity and sexually explicit content.

Meanwhile, Meta, through a blogpost on Tuesday, refuted the claims stating that it was categorically inaccurate to suggest that it knowingly and deliberately target ads featuring children to people based on an inappropriate interest in children.

"Quite the opposite; we use technology to identify accounts that have shown potentially suspicious activity related to children, and we have automatically removed over four-million of these accounts last year," Meta had said.

In another case of Meta-owned WhatsApp's 'username' notice by MeitY, the instant messaging company's response was due on Thursday, Krishnan informed.

Last Wednesday, the Centre issued a notice to Meta questioning the proposed username feature on WhatsApp, flagging concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams and impersonation attacks.

Last Friday, a team from Meta met officials in the IT Ministry following the notice summoning them. In the notice, the government asked Meta to explain why action shouldn't be initiated under the IT Act and Rules over WhatsApp's new feature that may increase cybercrimes.

When asked about the submission of its response on username, the company said: "The deadline is today and it will be submitted today."

Meanwhile, Krishnan also said the government will assess Meta's new Muse AI image generator under the existing legal framework.

AI not replacing jobs but enhancing human roles, says CEA

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran on Thursday allayed the fear of artificial intelligence taking away jobs and said that it rather enhances the value of the working professional.

He also urged Industry to develop capabilities to meet AI challenges while reminding that government has done its bit.

Addressing the GCC Business Summit hosted by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), he said artificial intelligence does not deploy or govern itself. "Someone has to design these systems. Someone has to train them, test them, correct them, and hold them to account. Someone has to decide where they should be used, and where they must not be. Someone has to carry the responsibility when they fail."

"That work is expanding, not shrinking. And a large and growing share of it is being done in India. AI does not empty these centres. In the centres that are run well, it raises the value of each person who works there," he said.

REVISED FRAMEWORK

Highlighting the role of government-industry collaboration, the CEA said the Budget has addressed a long-pending industry demand by simplifying and expanding the transfer pricing safe harbour regime for GCCs. The revised framework provides a uniform margin, significantly higher thresholds and faster, more predictable approvals over a multi-year period, improving tax certainty for such centres, he said. The government has also launched a national framework to encourage the expansion of GCCs beyond the six major metropolitan cities into tier-II and tier-III locations, he said. "This is not only an economic goal; it is a matter of fairness. The opportunity should not sit in a few metros alone," Nageswaran said.

LEVERAGING TECH. V Anantha Nageswaran, CEA, at the CII GCC Business Summit 2026

At the same time, he underlined that government policy alone cannot secure India's leadership in the sector. "The government can build the runway, but it cannot fly the plane. The move from cost to capability, from execution to innovation, has to be made by firms and by people," he said.

Nageswaran highlighted that India currently hosts approximately half of the world's GCCs, spanning over 2,000 centres that employ more than 2 million professionals. Sector revenues had crossed $60 billion, contributing nearly 2 per cent to the national GDP. He said that more than 1,200 of these centres perform advanced work in artificial intelligence and machine learning, establishing India as the second largest enterprise AI talent base globally.

He mentioned that global firms "first came to India for cost. They stayed for capability. That's an important difference. A cost advantage can be copied by the next low-cost country. A capability advantage is harder to build and harder to lose as well." He highlighted that global banks run trading platforms in Mumbai and Bengaluru, car makers design embedded systems in Chennai and Pune, and semiconductor firms carry out chip design locally. He cited German firm Merck's new campus in Bengaluru, which holds the company's largest concentration of digital capability worldwide, making India its fourth largest workforce hub.

thehindu businessline.

FRIDAY - JULY 10, 2026

All clear

EU clean chit to CCIL will boost financial flows

The extended stand-off between the European Securities Markets Authority (ESMA) and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has come to an amicable end — without compromising the stature or autonomy of Indian regulators and institutions. This could lead to a turnaround in investment ties between India and EU. ESMA has recognised Clearing Corporation of India Limited as a Tier 1 third country counterparty under European regulations.

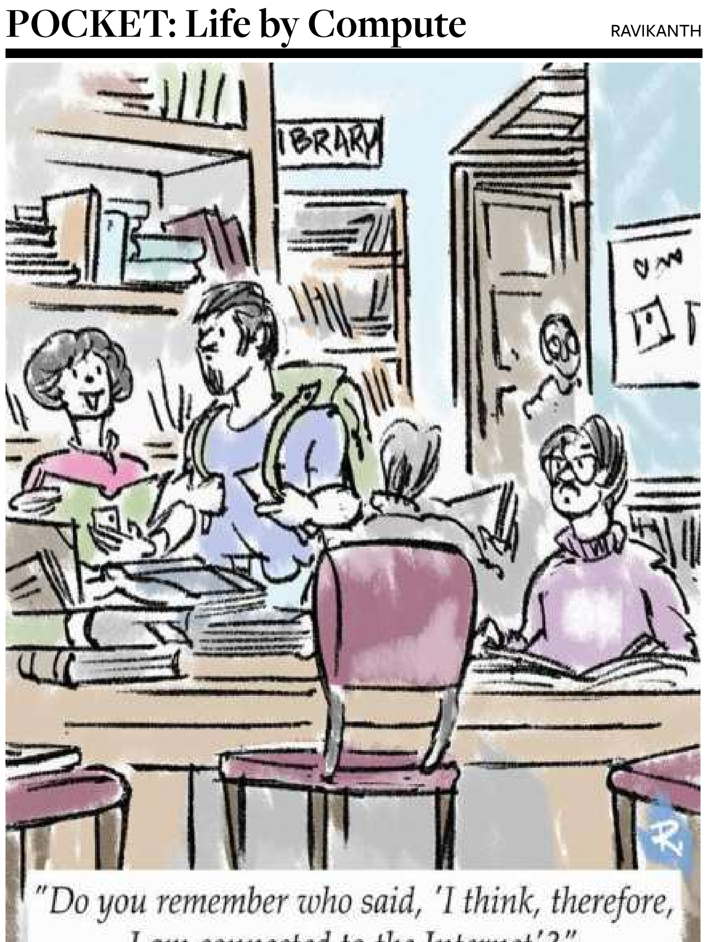
This allows clearing corporations, banks and investment companies from the EU region to clear their transactions through CCIL legally. Transaction costs for these entities will fall, paving the way for increased investments into India. Notably, the recognition does not allow the European markets regulator to oversee Indian clearing systems, thereby affirming the latter's robustness. The impasse began in 2023. RBI turned down the European regulator's demand that Indian clearing corporations be monitored, supervised and audited by ESMA, as mandated by the European Markets Infrastructure Regulations. Thereafter, Indian clearing houses were derecognised. Indian regulators naturally took objection to this demand, as it seemed to cast doubts on their supervisory capabilities — besides the prospect of allowing external regulators access to sensitive financial data. Even as the stalemate dragged on till late 2025, it is praiseworthy that RBI stood its ground. Meanwhile, European banks and investment companies witnessed a spike in their clearing cost due to the derecognition. A solution was arrived at during the EU President's visit to India in January, when RBI and ESMA signed a memorandum of understanding in this regard. The MoU states categorically that ESMA will rely on the regulatory framework of the RBI — thereby recognising that the RBI remains accountable in India for the activities of clearing corporations.

This recognition will go a long way towards improving cross border financial transactions between India and the EU. Institutions in the EU experienced an increase in transaction cost while clearing their deals through CCIL between 2023 and 2025. Dealing with a de-recognised clearing counterparty warrants higher risk buffers under EU regulations. Finding alternative routes for clearing money market, foreign exchange or bond investments turned out to be expensive. CCIL's recognition will be welcomed by global bond fund managers, who have ploughed money into India despite the rupee's weakness. Renewed flows will help support the rupee in these unpredictable times.

While FPIs have pulled out ₹2.68 lakh crore out of Indian equity markets so far in 2026, they have net purchased Indian debt securities amounting to ₹72,128 crore. Given the higher yields in India, global investors appear to be viewing Indian debt quite favourably. Along with the recent exemptions provided to FPIs from capital gains tax and tax on interest income from debt investments, enabling the CCIL to clear investments from EU will further promote investment flows.

POCKET: Life by Compute

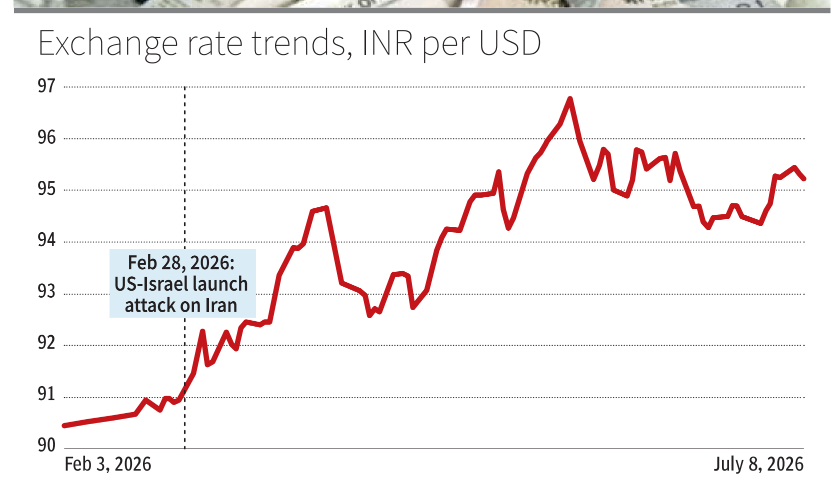
RAVIKANTH



Why currency stability is crucial

INDUSTRY HIT. Given exporters' reliance on imported intermediate goods, a weak rupee is not a competitive advantage

RAVI POKHARNA



Source: RBI

The rupee's breach of the psychological 96-per-US Dollar mark has triggered familiar anxieties. Yet, this episode is less a reflection of weak domestic fundamentals and more about geopolitical tensions, elevated crude oil prices, and a structurally stronger US dollar.

India is not alone. Several emerging market currencies are facing pressure as capital seeks safety in dollar-denominated assets amid heightened global uncertainty.

The challenge before policymakers is therefore not to prevent every episode of depreciation. In a market-driven economy, currencies inevitably adjust to external shocks. The real policy objective must be to ensure that currency movements remain orderly, predictable, and non-disruptive to growth and investment.

For industry, this distinction is critical. Businesses can adapt to a gradually adjusting exchange rate. What disrupts production cycles, investment planning, pricing decisions, and working capital management is abrupt and disorderly volatility.

ANATOMY OF DECLINE

The rupee's current trajectory stems from three distinct external shocks:

Geopolitical premium: The West Asia friction has escalated to a structural supply crisis with the near-closure of the Strait of Hormuz, through which 20 per cent of global energy supply transits. Consequently, the Indian crude oil basket surged from around $69/ bbl in February-2026 to $114.48/ bbl in April-2026 (PPAC). This primary energy shock accounted for over 70 per cent of India's import cost-push inflation; widening the Current Account Deficit and exerting structural pressure on the rupee (Observer Research Foundation)

Dollar imperative: Resilient US macroeconomic data, including an unemployment rate holding steady at 4.3 per cent (BLS), has reinforced a hawkish policy stance by the Federal Reserve. This has kept US yields elevated and sustained the strength of the Dollar Index (DXY), which continues to drive global capital into US assets.

Regional rotation: Shift toward safe-haven assets, triggered by the West Asia crisis, has seen global investors move out capital and reduce exposure to emerging markets. capital and reduce exposure to emerging markets. In India, the Net FPI equity outflow stands at ₹2.69 Lakh Crore YTD in 2026 (up to July 8, 2026). In contrast, for year 2025, the annual aggregate figure is ₹1.66 lakh crore. March-2026 saw the highest-ever monthly outflows, with foreign investors pulling out ₹1.17 lakh crore from domestic equities (NSDL)

WEAK RE VS EXPORTS

Conventional macroeconomics assumes that a weaker currency boosts exports and strengthens domestic manufacturing. That is now only partially true. India's manufacturing ecosystem today is deeply integrated into global supply chains and remains significantly dependent on imported intermediate goods, machinery and components. Consequently, currency depreciation is no longer an unambiguous competitive advantage.

For industries such as electronics, engineering goods, chemicals, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy equipment, and auto components, a weaker rupee raises input costs even as it improves export realisations. This trade-off is increasingly evident across sectors.

An electronics exporter may benefit from higher export earnings, but imported semiconductor components become costlier. Renewable energy developers face rising expenses for solar modules, battery cells, and storage systems, while chemical manufacturers contend with higher feedstock costs. Infrastructure and EPC projects also experience cost pressures where imported equipment is involved. Even textile exporters now depend on imported synthetic fibres and specialised inputs, limiting the gains from currency depreciation.

> **An electronics exporter may benefit from higher export earnings, but** imported semiconductor components become costlier

In an increasingly globalised economy, the traditional assumption that a weak rupee automatically boosts exports no longer holds true.

CURRENCY-GROWTH LINK

For industry, the larger concern today is imported production inflation and the resulting uncertainty across the investment cycle. India cannot sustainably aspire to become a global manufacturing hub if every external shock translates into rising industrial input costs, working-capital stress, and investment hesitation.

A prolonged period of elevated crude prices combined with rupee weakness simultaneously raises logistics costs, electricity tariffs, imported machinery prices, raw material costs, and financing burdens. The result is widespread margin compression across sectors. The challenge is particularly severe for MSMEs operating on thin margins, where even modest exchange-rate swings can materially affect profitability and cash flows.

This is why exchange-rate management can no longer be viewed solely as a monetary policy issue. Currency stability has now become a strategic industrial policy variable. True potential of Make in India, PLI, export-led manufacturing, and China+1 opportunity all depend on the ability of firms to operate within a reasonably predictable macroeconomic environment.

One of India's most powerful macroeconomic stabilisers is its global workforce. India received $135.4 billion in remittances in FY 2025 (Economic Survey 2025-26), making it the world's largest remittance recipient and providing an important cushion against external shocks. Policymakers must now view labour mobility, global skilling, and overseas workforce deployment as core pillars of external-sector resilience.

First, India should aggressively expand G2G skilled migration partnerships with labour-short economies. Much of the migration debate in India remains disproportionately focused on white-collar professionals in technology, finance, and consulting.

While these sectors remain important, an equally important opportunity lies in blue-collar segment. Several countries — Japan, Germany, Israel, Italy, Australia, and Gulf nations — are facing acute shortages across construction workers, welders, electricians, plumbers, caregivers, hospitality workers, manufacturing technicians et al., due to ageing populations and shrinking domestic labour pools. India possesses a significant demographic advantage in this context.

Second, India's skilling architecture must be more closely aligned with global labour market demand. The next phase of Skill India should not focus only on domestic employability, but on export-ready workforce creation. Language training, international certifications, digital capabilities, mobility-readiness programs should become key.

Finally, the policy ecosystem must support international talent integration through easier certification recognition, bilateral mobility frameworks, and digital trade facilitation. India must treat human capital mobility not as a peripheral labour issue, but as a central component of economic strategy and external-sector stability.

There is a tendency during periods of depreciation to equate currency weakness with economic weakness. This is analytically flawed. Many major economies, including export-oriented Asian economies, have historically tolerated periods of currency depreciation during external shocks. Exchange rates are adjustment mechanisms, not national scorecards.

India today enters this period from a position of significantly greater strength than in previous episodes of global stress. The task before policymakers now is to preserve macroeconomic stability, investment confidence, and growth momentum. At this moment of global uncertainty, stability and confidence may well be India's greatest competitive advantage.

The writer is Executive Director, Pahle India Foundation. With inputs from Kuntala Karkun, Senior Visiting Fellow, Pahle India Foundation

The minerals gap India cannot afford to ignore

India's demand for critical minerals is rising, and this could be leveraged by countries that control output and refining

Ganesh Valiachi

The next great resource contest is not over oil. It is over lithium, cobalt, graphite, and rare earth elements, the minerals without which no battery charges, no wind turbine turns, and no electric motor runs.

Major powers have recognised this. The US has committed $12 billion to strategic mineral stockpiling. The European Union has signed 15 supply partnerships. China already controls the refining of most of what the world needs. India has recognised it too, but recognition, so far, has not translated into urgency.

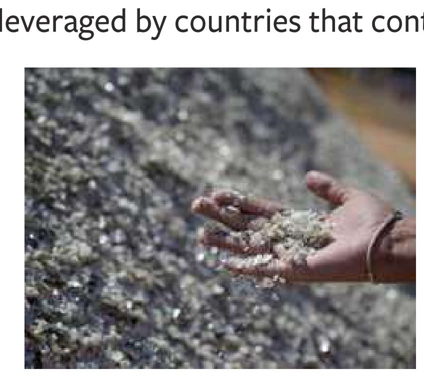
The world's supply of critical energy transition minerals (CETMs) is concentrated in the hands of a very few. The top three countries control 91 per cent of global cobalt mine output, 90 per cent of rare earth production, and 86 per cent of both graphite and lithium mine output. More critically, refining, where the real economic value is captured, is even more concentrated. China dominates the refining of rare earths, lithium, and cobalt. Indonesia controls 43 per cent of global nickel refining capacity.

India has set itself some of the most ambitious clean energy targets in the world: 500 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2030, aggressive EV adoption targets, and a rapidly growing semiconductor manufacturing ambition. Each of these goals is mineral-intensive.

India currently produces negligible quantities of most of these minerals domestically. It has limited refining capacity. And it has no significant strategic stockpile to buffer against supply disruptions, unlike Japan, which subsidises up to 50 per cent of eligible CETM project costs and maintains government-backed stockpiles, or the US, which in 2026 launched Project Vault, a $12-billion public-private critical mineral reserve. The gap between India's clean energy ambitions and its mineral security posture is, at present, very wide.

India already accounts for 4.4 per cent of global rare earth permanent magnet imports, a figure that will only grow as EV and wind capacity expand. Nearly all of it traces back to Chinese refining, a dependency that receives far less policy attention than it deserves.

The UNCTAD report documents that since 2020, nearly 100 new export restrictive measures have been introduced on CETMs globally: 37



RARE EARTHS. No time to lose REUTERS

licensing requirements, 31 export taxes, and 29 export bans. China alone has introduced 16 measures, predominantly licensing requirements framed around national security. The message is clear: countries that control critical minerals are increasingly willing to use that control as strategic leverage.

THE DIPLOMATIC GAP

The UNCTAD report identifies India as one of a small group of major economies leading the expansion of CETM bilateral partnerships, alongside the EU, the US, Canada, Indonesia, and Japan. This recognition is welcome. But recognition of intent is not the same as demonstrated capacity.

The US signed 11 bilateral mineral frameworks at a single ministerial meeting in February 2026, involving 54 countries. The EU has signed 15 strategic mineral partnerships, backed by a €2 billion European Investment Bank financing commitment.

India's bilateral engagement, while growing, has not yet reached a comparable scale, speed, or financial commitment. The window for securing favourable partnerships with mineral-rich nations, particularly in Africa and Latin America, is competitive and narrowing.

Countries like the DRC, Zimbabwe, and Zambia are being actively courted by multiple major powers simultaneously. India cannot afford a leisurely diplomatic pace.

India possesses significant rare earth deposits that remain underexploited, and diplomatic credibility with mineral-rich developing nations that could be leveraged more effectively than they currently are.

The global race for critical minerals is already well underway. India needs to run analytically, strategically, and with conviction.

The writer is an Assistant Professor at Symbiosis Institute of International Business, Pune. Views are personal

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Defending E20 petrol

This refers to the report 'ISMA defends E20 petrol, says social media claims lack scientific backing' (July 9). The sugar industry body, which obviously has a conflict of interest in the promotion of ethanol, has come to the government's rescue for its decision on E20 petrol.

It is perplexing why the government maintains that no E20-related engine failure incident has come to its attention when many motorists have shared their experience of fuel pump damage due to the E20 petrol, with video evidence. Why would one object to blended petrol if it actually benefited them? The government should not dismiss consumers' concerns when a majority of on-road vehicles in the country are from the pre-2023 period.

Even before the Supreme Court, the government has recently admitted that "mixing ethanol with petrol is only an experiment, whose results would come by next year." Many experts even warn that ethanol saves less fossil fuel energy than it directly and indirectly takes to produce.

Kamal Laddha

Bengaluru

Trump's another shock

Apropos 'Sensex tanks over 2% as crude on West Asia war fears' (July 9). Donald Trump's remark that the ceasefire with Iran had effectively collapsed has rekindled fears of a wider West Asia conflict.

The renewed tensions triggered a sharp fall in Indian equities, with the Sensex plunging over 2 per cent amid rising crude oil prices. These developments threaten global economic and financial stability. The US and Iran must act with restraint and revive diplomatic efforts.

PV Prakash

Mumbai

Monsoon worries

Apropos the article 'Monsoon dependency remains' (July 9), the writer rightly highlights that Indian agriculture continues to depend heavily on the monsoon despite expanded irrigation facilities.

While the article effectively stresses the need for climate-resilient farming and efficient water management, it could also have highlighted successful examples of watershed development and rainwater harvesting that have reduced monsoon dependence in several regions.

P Mehalingam

Virudhunagar

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Container ports lagging

Indian ports need to join hands with global majors

Jose Paul

PORTS. Time to catch up PTI

Recent media reports suggest that India's container ports have climbed to 6th position globally as throughput has reached 24 million TEUs (Twenty Foot Equivalent units) in 2025. This does not reflect the factual position. The latest Lloyd's List and Alphaliner publications suggest that Indian container ports remain far behind many container ports in Asia, Europe and the US.

Shanghai has handled 55 million TEUs in 2025 – more than twice the combined annual container traffic of all Indian ports. Out of the 30 top container ports in the world, 11 are Chinese ports.

Singapore continues to remain at the second place having handled 44.6 million TEUs in 2025. Singapore Port Authority has developed an ambitious developmental plan by creating TUAS port which represents the "Future of the Singapore Transhipment Hub".

However, Singapore is now facing a strong challenge by the Chinese Port of Ningbo-Zhoushan which is closely behind having handled 43.8 million TEUs.

Port of Busan in South Korea has remained consistently at the 7th place having handled 24.8 million TEUs. South Korean government with private participation plans to invest more than $35 billion for developing 12 ports in the next 20 years to increase their ship handling capacity. Laem Chabang in Thailand has maintained its position as the 18th largest port handling 10.4 million TEUs. Port of Ho Chi Minh city in Vietnam has sprung a surprise by elevating its rank to the 20th position by handling 10 million TEUs. It is important to note that Colombo is still ahead of the two premier Indian ports of Mundra and the J N Port in Nhava Sheva having been placed at the 24th, 25th and 26th positions respectively.

Although containerization originated from the US port developments in the US did not keep pace with the developments in container shipping.

The US and European ports lagged behind due to a number of regulatory and procedural delays influenced by environmental issues. During the last two decades Asian ports made substantial improvements in the modernisation of ports embracing new technology and were able to accommodate third and fourth generation container ships upto 25,000 TEUs.

SEEKING PARTNERS

Indian ports need to collaborate and partner with global container shipping giants to develop sustainable port infrastructure. The recent collaborative deal of Adani Ports offering 49 per cent stake in Vizhinjam port for ₹13,000 crore to the largest container shipping line Mediterranean Shipping Company is a model worth considering.

Another example is the APM Terminal of Pipava Port in Gujarat where the world's second largest container line Maersk's terminal arm APM terminals has partnered with the port for management and operations. It holds a majority stake in Gujarat Pipavav port Ltd.

The Malaysian port Tanjung Pelepas has partnered with APM terminals with a 30 per cent stake and it has become the 13th largest container port in the world within 25 years of its existence. The JM Baxi Group has partnered with the third largest container line CMA/CGM and the fifth largest container line Hapag-Lloyd for their terminal development, management and operations in Mumbai and Tuticorin ports.

Cochin Port's container terminal operator DP World would do well by partnering with one of the largest container shipping lines for more efficient, faster and sustainable development in a highly competitive market environment.

It is important to note that seven largest container shipping lines — Mediterranean Shipping Co, A P Moller-Maersk, CMA/CGM Group, COSCO Shipping Lines, Hapag-Lloyd, Ocean Network Express and Evergreen Marine control 74 per cent of the global container market share and, therefore, they have the capacity, power and influence in port selection and direction of container trade.

The writer is a former Chairman of Mormugao Port Trust, and an Adjunct Professor of Indian Maritime University, Chennai.

AI's next challenge is industrialisation

EMBEDDING AI. India must strive to become the world's most credible laboratory for deploying AI inside real economic systems

GETTY IMAGES

VIPIN SONDHI
G SUNDARARAMAN

Many years ago, on the shop floor of a plant manufacturing heavy engineering equipment, we watched a robotic welding cell come alive. The trials went exactly as promised; clean welds, consistent cycle times, an engineer beaming beside the control panel. The machine worked.

What took the next 18 months was something else. Qualifying the wire feed across three shifts. Training operators who had welded by hand for 20 years to trust a system they could not see inside. Building a maintenance regime that did not exist yet.

By the time that cell ran reliably across volumes, the technology had become the smallest part of the story.

A near-identical lesson came from the digital side. When a Dealer Business Management System was deployed across a national dealer network of a large automobile company, provisioning took weeks; operational alignment took nearly two years standardising workflows, cleansing field data, converting users from manual habits. The technology was again the smallest part of the story.

We think about both examples when we sit through AI demonstrations today. The question is no longer whether AI works. The demonstrations have settled that. What remains unsettled is whether organisations can deploy it reliably and at scale.

The first phase of AI was a demonstration phase and a remarkable one. Models that write serviceable code, draft contracts, summarise board papers and pass examinations were, a few years ago, improbable. But it has stopped being the interesting question.

Inside many organisations today, almost every function can show a pilot. Far fewer can show AI embedded in how the organisation runs, week after week, without a champion keeping it alive.

The gap between a pilot and a system is not a technology gap. It is an industrialisation gap. And it is exactly the gap manufacturing spent a century learning to close.

WHY PILOTS ARE EASY

Pilots succeed for reasons that have little to do with the technology. Data is curated by the team that wants the pilot to work. Users are the most capable people in the building. The problem is narrowed until it fits inside what the model can do. None of this is dishonest. It is how any controlled trial behaves.

Scaling removes every one of those conditions at once.

The data that looked clean in one plant turns out inconsistent across 12. The workflow built for an early-adopter team must survive contact with a function that never asked for it. Accountability, informal during the pilot, must now be designed. Who owns the decision when it goes wrong?

India's own transport policy offers a precise illustration. In 2015, Rule 118 mandated Speed Limiting Devices on commercial vehicles, sealed by the transport authority to prevent tampering.

The device worked exactly as specified. But a sealed component is not a monitored system: without live tracking behind it, seals were routinely broken and devices bypassed. Compliance on the road stayed inconsistent for years. The lesson was not that the device failed. It was that a component, however well engineered, cannot industrialise itself.

> **The engineers and managers capturing disproportionate value are not those using AI cleverly in isolation, but those** who hold a model's output against business judgment, regulatory constraint and operational reality at once

A factory floor, an enterprise network, a national regulatory mandate: three domains, one lesson. Scale is also financial. Running millions of decisions every day costs far more than running a few thousand test queries. The gap catches most organisations by surprise.

The answer is leaner AI purpose-built for specific tasks, not large models for everything. Scale is not only an operational challenge. It is a financial one.

INFRA OVER INTELLIGENCE

This is why the centre of gravity in serious AI conversations is moving from the model to everything around it. Data architecture, governance, security and the unglamorous plumbing that determines whether intelligence survives contact with a real organisation.

Across sectors, enterprises are expected to shift from buying off-the-shelf AI to building it in-house, recognising that the advantage lies in integration depth, not model access.

A capable model does not redeem a weak operating system. It accelerates it surfacing problems the organisation had perhaps quietly agreed to ignore.

Manufacturing leaders recognise this instinctively. A new machine tool does not fix poor scheduling discipline, it simply produces the same defects faster, at higher cost.

AI follows the same logic. Organisations treating it as a software upgrade rather than an operating-system question are most likely to be disappointed and most surprised, since the model performed exactly as advertised.

Industrialisation also changes who does the work, not only how. The most valuable people on a shop floor are rarely pure specialists. They connect a process problem to a materials answer and a cost constraint in one sentence. AI is producing the same demand at the desk.

The engineers and managers capturing disproportionate value are not those using AI cleverly in isolation, but those who hold a model's output against business judgment, regulatory constraint and operational reality at once. That is a systems skill, not a technical one and scarcest in most organisations. Capability is migrating from performing tasks to integrating systems and the gap is widening faster than most systems acknowledge.

STRUCTURAL ARBITRAGE

The opportunity for India here is large.

The global conversation remains fixated on who builds the largest model which is an expensive race, with entry costs in the billions. The industrialisation race rewards different capabilities and India has been building them for two decades without recognising that as preparation.

Consider what India has already achieved at scale. Aadhaar authenticates a billion identities in real time, across infrastructure of sharply uneven quality. UPI processes more transactions than most nations settle in a year. These are not technology achievements. They are industrialisation achievements; embedding digital systems into a fragmented multi-lingual economy and making them work reliably at volume. That capability is what the AI race will reward.

The more durable ambition is not to build the most powerful model. It is to become the world's most credible laboratory for deploying AI inside real economic systems — manufacturing lines, hospital networks, logistics corridors, agricultural supply chains — reliably enough so that the world studies the deployment, not the demonstration.

Viksit Bharat 2047 will be built less on who invents AI first than on who industrialises it first; at scale, across real systems, without losing reliability. Invention proves what a machine can do. Industrialisation decides who benefits from it.

Sondhi is Independent Director: Global–India; former MD & CEO, Ashok Leyland and JCB India; Sundararaman is Chief Scientist and Head of Wipro Research. Views are personal

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

July 10, 2006

ChrysCapital to invest $555 m in India

Private equity firm ChrysCapital is planning to invest $555 million in India over the next 3-4 years from its fourth fund. The firm has already made one investment from this fund and is close to in king another in the manufacturing domain within the next couple of weeks.

Indian cos go in for large-sized global buys

India Inc is not only scaling up the size of its overseas acquisitions but there have been several instances of Indian firms buying out companies abroad that are larger in size compared to them. Tata Coffee's buyout of the third largest coffee chain in the US, Eight O'Clock (EOC), at an estimated $220 million (Rs 1,019.4 crore) is a case in point.

MUL-Bellsonica venture cleared

Maruti Udyog Ltd's (MUL) plan to set up a joint venture with the Japan-based Bellsonica Corporation has been cleared by the Government. The initial plan, in which there was the possibility of having another Indian company as the third partner, has been changed. According to the proposal, Maruti will hold 30 per cent in the joint venture and Bellsonica the rest, sources said.

Oman says allies ships going through Hormuz may have to pay

Samy Adghirni
Fiona MacDonald
Ania Nussbaum

Oman has told European officials there's no way of going back to the pre-war status quo with the Strait of Hormuz and transiting ships may have to be charged some fees, according to people familiar with the matter.

While Omani officials said they will always abide by international maritime law, they added there could be fees for services related to de-polluting the strait or helping ships navigate it, the people said, asking not to be named discussing private matters. It's unclear if Oman said all these fees would be obligatory.

Oman is analysing systems used for chokepoints across the globe, including the Malacca strait in Asia, said the people, an area where there are no mandatory shipping charges.

The US, Europe and Oman's Gulf Arab neighbours are increasingly concerned the sultanate will set up a tolling or fee system with Iran for the Strait of Hormuz. French President Emmanuel Macron will meet Oman's leader, Sultan Haitham bin Tariq, in

THE STRAIT. Vital passage REUTERS

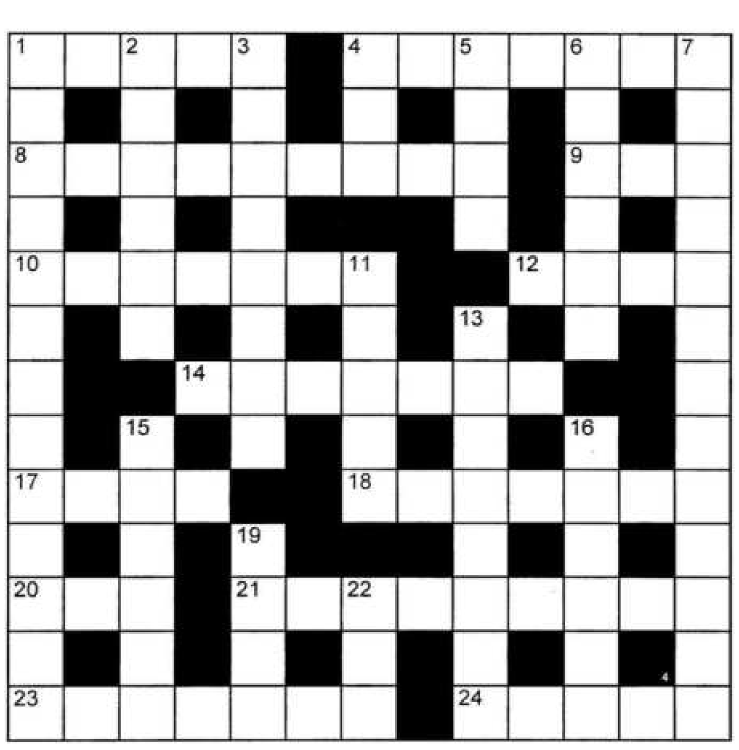
Paris on Monday, as world powers step up efforts to ensure free passage through the strait continues.

The two leaders will "address the security of maritime routes, which depends on free and unconditional passage through the Strait of Hormuz," according to Macron's office.

Oman's foreign ministry and its embassy in France did not immediately respond to requests for comment on Friday, the start of the country's weekend. Oman and Iran border the narrow waterway. Iran shut the strait by attacking and threatening ships from late February, when the US and Israel started bombing the Islamic Republic. With the US and Iran now in peace talks, Tehran is insisting it will jointly manage traffic with Oman.

BLOOMBERG

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2690



EASY

ACROSS

01. Mass of unwrought gold, etc (5)
04. Rider's foot support (7)
08. Pacific (9)
09. Preclude (3)
10. Makes liked (7)
12. Ultramarine (4)
14. Various, sundry (7)
17. Musician's numbered work (4)
18. Tuneful (7)
20. Type, kind (3)
21. Social, jovial (9)
23. Foot-lever operating machine (7)
24. One dead or ruined beyond recovery (5)

DOWN

01. Painter of 19th c school (13)
02. Protects from danger (6)
03. Young person (8)
04. Catch breath in sorrow (3)
05. One thing in list (4)
06. Foul-mouthed, coarse (6)
07. Vertical (13)
11. Water vapour (5)
13. Leaping over horse (8)
15. Belt fastener (6)
16. ________ Mole, his diary (6)
19. (Clouds) sweep along easily (4)
22. Indication of maiden name (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

01. Gin to be exchanged for a bar of gold (5)
04. Sort of pump one could get one's foot into (7)
08. Not wanting a fight, though capable of using twice the energy (9)
09. Except for this, it's a drinking-place (3)
10. Makes oneself liked, which will finish off the listeners (7)
12. A sad athlete representing his university (4)
14. Some are always in little Sarah's embrace (7)
17. A work put up so awkwardly (4)
18. Tuneful as old mice can be (7)
20. The sort to remove the top of the pinta (3)
21. In party spirits I join Viv, Al and Can for a get-together (9)
23. Foot-worked machine part can be altered (7)
24. He's had it, one being taken in by King George (5)

DOWN

01. Artist who gave an impersonation would sit around (13)
02. Keeps watch over regiments of soldiers (6)
03. One is one for seven years (8)
04. Sound unhappy, therefore start blubbing (3)
05. Something listed as a couple regarded as one (4)
06. Very rude about Blair on the day (6)
07. The style is Gothic – straight up! (13)
11. How ship would put to sea in the days after sail (5)
13. Is leaping at this type of ceiling (8)
15. The fastener may bend and break (6)
16. Boy and air he disturbs (6)
19. Driven cloud they made a missile of (4)
22. Born, as a woman, in endless want (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2689

ACROSS 2. Diver 5. Cage 7. Garb 8. Ulterior 9. Frighten 11. Axle 12. Insubstantial 15. Plot 17. Referral 19. Overlook 21. Drag 22. Grab 23. Serum

DOWN 1. Chagrin 2. Dub 3. Vaunt 4. Rotunda 5. Cor 6. Growl 10. Gaunt 11. After 13. Serious 14. Adamant 16. Lover 18. Fakir 20. Rob 21. Dam

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SBI Funds Management fixes IPO price band at ₹545-574 a share

ON OFFER. Issue priced lower than its peers to make it attractive for retail investors, says MD & CEO

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The country's largest mutual fund house, SBI Funds Management, has priced its initial public offering at ₹545 to ₹574 a share of face value ₹1.

The promoters of the fund house — SBI and European fund management company Amundi India Holdings — will offload 12.83 crore shares and 7.54 crore shares, respectively, to collectively raise ₹11,692 crore.

The subscription will open on July 14. The fund house manages assets worth ₹12.51 lakh crore and has a mutual fund market share of 15 per cent as of March-end.

Its total AUM, including portfolio management services and other advisory mandates, was ₹29.46 lakh crore as of March-end.

Debasish Mishra, Managing Director and CEO, SBI Funds Management, said the IPO had been proposed by the promoters not for just fund-raising but also to bring in more visibility, transparency and enhanced governance in the fund house.

The issue had been priced lower than its peers to make it attractive for retail investors and leave some money for prospective investors, he said. Just like SBI has an official tag line "Banker to every Indian", he added the fund house aspires to become the fund manager to every Indian.

On hitting the primary market during volatile times, Mishra said rather than waiting for an appropriate time, the issue will rejuvenate market sentiment and attract investors, given its growth potential.

MEGA IPO. (From left) Denys De Campigneulles, Deputy CEO, SBI Funds Management; Debasish Mishra, MD and CEO; and DP Singh, Joint CEO, giving the details of the ₹11,692 crore issue PTI

AUM GROWTH

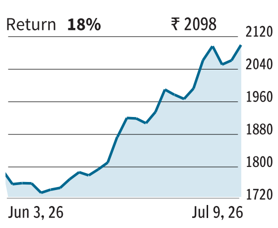
The company is also India's largest passive asset manager with passive ₹4.05 lakh crore representing a market share of 28 per cent as of March end. Its total quarterly average AUM has grown at a compound annual growth rate of 14 per cent in the last three fiscals, while its mutual fund QAAUM was up at a CAGR of 17 per cent during the same period.

DP Singh, Deputy Managing Director, SBI Funds Management, said the fund house had huge growth opportunity just by tapping into the 95 crore SBI bank account holders and even after setting aside Jan Dhan account holders, the number of potential customers works out to about 55 crore. The fund house has the largest SIP inflow of ₹4,000 crore per month and has 55 lakh unique investors.

Srinivas Jain, Executive President, SBI Funds Management, said the fund house had consistently using AI to improve compliance, research and check points to detect possible insider trading by collating data.

QUICKLY.

Anand Rathi Wealth net profit up 24% in Q1



Mumbai: Anand Rathi Wealth reported that its net profit in the June quarter was up 24 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to ₹116 crore. Revenue increased 18 per cent to ₹336 crore, while assets under management grew 21 per cent y-o-y to ₹ 1,06,300 crore. Rakesh Rawal, Chief Executive Officer, said that despite the volatile equity market environment, the uncomplicated business model and unwavering focus on client outcomes enabled the company to deliver consistent and market-agnostic growth, reinforcing the resilience and scalability of business. OUR BUREAU

Custodian fee can be paid monthly now: SEBI

Mumbai: SEBI has amended the custodian regulations to replace the existing annual fee mechanism for custodians with a monthly fee payment system. The amendments will come into force on October 1. Custodians will pay ₹85,000 per month or 0.0000416 per cent of their assets under custody, whichever is higher, instead of the existing annual fee of ₹10 lakh or 0.0005 per cent of assets under custody. They have to pay the monthly fee within 15 days from the end of each month. For custodians registered before October 1, SEBI has provided a transition mechanism. They will pay a proportionate annual fee up to September 30 and shift to monthly fee payments from October 1. OUR BUREAU

HC rejects NSE ex-chief's plea on PC Act provisions, upholds prosecution sanction

Asian News International
New Delhi

Chitra Ramkrishna

The Delhi High Court on Thursday dismissed a petition filed by former National Stock Exchange (NSE) Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Chitra Ramkrishna challenging the constitutional validity of the definitions of "public duty" and "public servant" under the Prevention of Corruption Act (PC Act), holding that the NSE performs functions of public importance and its top executive cannot be divorced from those functions.

A Division Bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dudeja held that the NSE discharges a public duty and that Ramkrishna, as its MD and CEO during the relevant period, cannot be wholly separated from the functions performed by the exchange, in which the public at large has a significant interest.

The Bench also rejected Ramkrishna's challenge to the sanction granted for her prosecution under the Prevention of Corruption Act. "We have rejected your submission on the sanction order. We do not find any merit in the present petition. The same, along with applications, is accordingly dismissed," the court observed while pronouncing the order.

LEGAL CHALLENGE

Ramkrishna had approached the High Court, contending that the definitions of "public duty" and "public servant" under the Prevention of Corruption Act were unconstitutional and overly broad, arguing that they improperly brought officials of private bodies, such as the NSE, within the ambit of the anti-corruption law. She also questioned the validity of the prosecution sanction granted against her.

The High Court, however, declined to accept these contentions, effectively clearing the way for the criminal proceedings against her to continue.

CO-LOCATION CASE

The case arises out of the CBI's investigation into the alleged irregularities at the NSE, including the co-location matter. The CBI has alleged that Ramkrishna abused her official position during her tenure as the head of the country's largest stock exchange.

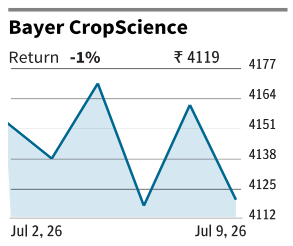
The Enforcement Directorate is also investigating the matter under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act based on the CBI case. Ramkrishna is presently on bail in both the cases.

Earlier, while hearing the matter, the High Court reserved its judgment after considering Ramkrishna's challenge to the statutory provisions and the validity of the prosecution sanction.

With Thursday's verdict, the Division Bench has upheld the applicability of the Prevention of Corruption Act to the facts of the case and dismissed all the pleas raised by the former NSE chief.

Bayer AG buys 11.9% stake in CropScience for ₹2,207 cr

Press Trust of India
New Delhi



German multinational Bayer AG has bought a 11.9 per cent stake in Bayer CropScience for ₹2,207 crore through a block deal, according to data available on the NSE.

Shares of Bayer CropScience slipped 1 per cent to ₹4,120.20 on the NSE on Thursday.

Bayer AG, a promoter entity, purchased 53,54,030 shares, representing a 11.91 per cent stake, in agrochemical company Bayer CropScience.

The transactions were executed on Wednesday at an average price of ₹4,122.30.

STAKE SALE

Meanwhile, Bayer CropScience Aktiengesellschaft (AG), one of the promoters, sold an equal number of shares and exited the firm. The transaction was an inter-promoter transfer and did not alter the overall promoter shareholding.

Markets shrug off West Asia tensions, close in the green

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets staged a measured recovery on Thursday, bouncing back from Wednesday's sharp sell-off even as the US and Iran exchanged military strikes for a second consecutive day. The rebound came despite crude oil holding near $79 a barrel and the Strait of Hormuz situation remaining unresolved, signalling that domestic markets had largely priced in the conflict.

"The recovery was primarily supported by easing concerns over West Asia after indications that Iran was willing to resume negotiations, which helped cool crude oil prices from their recent highs," said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking. "Continued foreign institutional buying and a decline in the India VIX further supported sentiment."

The Sensex gained 238 points to close at 76,741.82, while the Nifty 50 added 80.75 points to 23,962.80. The broader markets outperformed the benchmarks, with the Nifty Midcap 100 advancing 1.38 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 surging 1.8 per cent. Advancing stocks outnumbered decliners by 3:1 ratio.

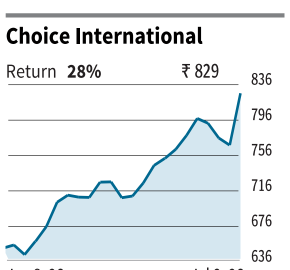
REALTY SURGES

Sectorally, Realty led the charge with gains of over 3.3 per cent, followed by Media, PSU Banks and Consumer Durables. IT and Auto were the only sectors to close in the red, with IT under pressure ahead of TCS results.

The IMF's reaffirmation of India as the world's fastest-growing major economy, revising the FY28 growth forecast upward to 6.7 per cent even as it marginally trimmed the FY27 projection to 6.4 per cent, also bolstered sentiment.

S. Korea's NHIS to invest ₹900 cr in Choice broking

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Choice International Ltd on Thursday announced that NH Investment & Securities (NHIS), a South Korean financial institution and subsidiary of the NH Financial Group, will invest ₹900 crore in Choice Equity Broking Private Ltd (CEBPL), the broking and wealth management arm of Choice.

The firm operates over 65 branches globally with a workforce exceeding 3,000 professionals.

FUND DEPLOYMENT

The investment will be structured through compulsorily convertible preference shares (CCPS). Proceeds will fund the expansion of Choice's margin trading facility (MTF) book, technology upgrades, customer acquisition, talent development and product innovation.

NHIS, founded in 1969 and headquartered in Seoul, reported revenue of approximately KRW 15.36 trillion in FY25; it holds a market capitalisation of roughly KRW 10.9 trillion as of June 2026.

AMBITIOUS TARGET

CEBPL has set a target of 5x growth across the broking and distribution businesses over the next three years, backed by this capital infusion. Choice CEO Arun Poddar said the partnership would enhance customer experience and expand access to financial products.

NHIS President Shin Jae Wook described the deal as strengthening his firm's global business portfolio.

The transaction is subject to customary regulatory approvals.

Millworks Tech plans ₹160 crore IPO on BSE arm

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Millworks Technologies, a leading manufacturer of high-accuracy machined components, plans to raise ₹160 crore through IPO on BSE SME platform.

The company will issue 48.44 lakh shares in the price band of ₹ 315-331 a share.

The IPO will open for subscription on Tuesday.

The net proceeds from the IPO will be used for capital expenditure to purchase plant and machinery, working capital requirements and the general corporate purposes.

Sridhar Acharya, Promoter & MD, Millworks Technologies, said the company had adopted latest technology to ensure best of quality standards through a dedicated team.

The IPO marks the beginning of a chapter that will accelerate growth, expand capabilities and strengthen commitment to innovation, he added.

India's listed new-age firms may touch $1 trillion market cap by 2030: Redseer

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

India's listed new-age ecosystem is projected to reach $1 trillion market capitalisation by 2030, driven by a robust pipeline of companies preparing to tap public markets, according to a report released by strategy consulting firm Redseer on Thursday.

The report, *Redseer India IPO Report: 2026*, said the country currently had around 210 new-age companies that are IPO-ready over the next 24 months, identified through an assessment of 1,400 firms.

Based on an analysis of more than 300 mainboard IPOs between FY21 and FY26, the report said India's listed new-age companies currently account for around $150 billion in market capitalisation, or about 4.6 per cent of the country's total market value.

> Based on an analysis of over 300 mainboard IPOs between FY21 and FY26, new-age companies currently account for around $150 b in m-cap

This share could expand to nearly 11.5 per cent by 2030 under Redseer's base-case scenario.

IPO MOMENTUM

The report noted that India's IPO market had grown nearly eight-fold in terms of proceeds over the past decade, making it the only major capital market to sustain uninterrupted growth in primary issuances. India now ranks third globally in IPO proceeds.

According to the report, the country's IPO market had also become more resilient due to rising participation by domestic institutional investors, including mutual funds, insurers and pension funds. This has reduced the market's dependence on foreign capital during periods of global volatility.

Among new-age firms that went public between FY22 and FY26, the proportion of companies reporting profits after tax at the time of listing increased from 50 per cent to 70 per cent, while median pre-IPO revenue growth moderated from 50 per cent to 33 per cent.

BROKER'S CALL.

Keynote Capitals

DIXON TECHNOLOGIES (BUY)
Target: ₹16,608
CMP: ₹13,490

Dixon Technologies (India) (DTIL) is venturing into specialty EMS verticals such as aerospace, automotive, defence, medical and industrial electronics. Its increasing focus on specialty EMS is aimed at diversifying revenue streams, reducing dependence on consumer-led cyclicality and improving the overall margin profile.

It is progressively moving beyond pure-play assembly towards deeper backward integration across key components such as camera modules, display modules, display fabrication and other critical components. The acquisition of a 51 per cent stake in Q-Tech India gives access to camera and fingerprint module manufacturing for smartphones, IoT and automotive applications. In displays, the JV with HKC Corporation provides in-house LCD and OLED manufacturing capability.

DTIL is in advanced stages of securing FDI approval for its proposed JV with Vivo. Post formalisation, the partnership is expected to contribute nearly 67 per cent of Vivo's handset volumes, translating into 20-22 million units per annum. This can materially improve DTIL's mobile phone volumes and create a stable revenue stream for the mobile segment.

We estimate DTIL to deliver revenue growth of 20-25 per cent over FY27-29, supported by the Vivo JV, subject to approval. The company's expansion across telecom, IT hardware, camera modules, displays, hearables and wearables should provide additional medium-term growth levers. We initiate coverage on DTIL with a Buy rating, valuing the company at 65x FY28E P/E.

Equirus Securities

ADITYA INFOTECH (ADD)
Target: ₹3,800
CMP: ₹3,643.65

Aditya Infotech (AIL), through its CP PLUS brand, is India's leading surveillance player with over 40 per cent market share. Its vertically-integrated business model is supported by a large domestic manufacturing footprint, over 54 STQC-certified IP camera models and an extensive distribution network. STQC norms, localisation and backward integration favour compliant domestic manufacturers, positioning AIL to benefit from lower dependence on Chinese imports + substitution, stronger supply-chain control and margin expansion. AIL delivered a revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of about 23 per cent/52 per cent/48 per cent over FY23-26. We forecast about 36 per cent/45 per cent/47 per cent CAGR over FY26-29E, driven by a richer CP PLUS (own-brand) mix, localisation and operating leverage, lifting EBITDA margins from about 8 per cent in FY25 to about 16 per cent by FY29E. Pre-tax RoCE is expected to improve from about 38.6 per cent in FY26 to about 41.1 per cent by FY28E, supporting a premium valuation. We expect AIL to deliver robust earnings growth driven by market share gains, premiumisation and operating leverage. However, following the sharp post-listing rerating and with competition likely to intensify as more players secure STQC approvals, we believe the risk-reward is balanced.

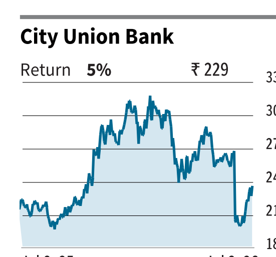
However, with much of the operating upside already priced in, we initiate coverage with Add and a September 2027 TP of ₹3,800 (45x September 2028 EPS).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

City Union Bank (₹229.15): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for City Union Bank. The stock has been rising well since last month.

The support level of ₹218 has limited the downside during the sharp fall this week on Wednesday.

City Union Bank share price can rise to ₹245 in a week or two. Traders can buy City Union Bank shares now at ₹230. Accumulate on dips at ₹223. Keep the stop-loss at ₹215.

Trail the stop-loss up to ₹232 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹235. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹236 and ₹240 when the share price touches ₹239 and ₹242 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹245. The bullish view will go wrong if the price declines below ₹218. If that happens, a fall to ₹200 is possible. So, adhere to the stop-loss and exit.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24005 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24860	24800	24075	24180	Go short now and at 24060. Keep the stop-loss at 24105

₹817 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
814	812	824	832	Go long on a bounce from 814. Keep the stop-loss at 813

₹1055 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1040	1025	1070	1090	Take fresh shorts below 1040. Keep the stop-loss at 1045

₹282 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
280	275	285	288	Go short only below 280. Stop-loss can be kept at 282

₹244 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
240	236	246	249	Go short on a rise at 245. Keep the stop-loss at 247

₹1281 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1265	1240	1295	1315	Take fresh shorts below 1265 with a stop-loss at 1275

₹1022 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1015	1000	1030	1040	Go short only below 1015. Keep the stop-loss at 1020

₹2059 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2030	1980	2085	2120	Go short on a break below 2030. Keep the stop-loss at 2040

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 80.75 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Bharti Airtel	1931.10	28.56	34.79	5.35
HDFC Bank	817.55	24.25	15.89	11.41
Sun Pharma	1938.70	11.68	40.42	1.87
Kotak Bank	377.15	11.34	19.45	2.53
Eternal Ltd.	292.45	9.08	771.11	1.93
Reliance Ind	1279.80	5.75	18.09	7.88
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1031.70	5.29	24.21	1.32
IntGlobeAvi	5229.50	5.22	0.00	1.08
Bajaj Finserv	1895.00	5.07	15.42	1.00
Grasim Ind	3191.90	4.71	21.09	1.10
State Bank	1022.10	4.69	10.89	3.85
UltraTech Cement	11524.00	4.42	41.47	1.24
SBI Life	1821.70	3.21	73.98	0.75
ITC	282.05	2.95	16.81	2.48
Max Healthcare	1101.30	2.68	74.31	0.75
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	233.37	2.42	98.72	0.70
TataConsumerProduct	1106.70	2.40	70.81	0.66
Adani Enter	3083.60	2.31	40.31	0.81
Apollo Hosp	8845.50	2.07	63.51	0.83
NestleIndia	1463.20	1.99	80.64	0.96
Hind Unilever	2144.50	1.69	47.62	1.73
PowerGrid Corp	281.35	1.63	16.43	1.16
Adani Ports	1800.10	1.35	32.45	1.21
JSW Steel	1225.80	1.29	11.75	1.05
Cipla	1441.30	1.17	30.15	0.74
HCL Tech	1150.40	1.11	18.75	1.11
Asian Paints	2673.80	0.78	58.36	1.10
Coal India	429.90	0.44	8.53	0.94
ICICI Bank	1380.70	0.16	17.10	9.01
Wipro	172.76	0.03	13.68	0.45
Bajaj Auto	10155.00	-0.22	26.84	1.03
Tata Motors PV	331.50	-0.25	4069.53	0.63
Tech Mahindra	1426.30	-0.35	29.09	0.83
Tata Steel	187.91	-0.52	21.55	1.42
HDFC Life	551.85	-0.90	62.27	0.54
Bharat Elec	406.20	-1.10	48.98	1.33
Trent Ltd.	2904.10	-1.45	89.97	0.88
L&T	3886.00	-1.56	28.21	4.15
Eicher Motors	7361.00	-1.73	36.64	0.92
TCS	2049.50	-1.78	14.99	1.91
Hindalco	963.45	-2.59	16.17	1.27
Titan	4555.80	-2.76	79.71	1.71
ONGC	243.65	-2.84	6.16	0.86
M&M	3085.40	-3.33	20.60	2.51
Bajaj Finance	1003.80	-3.86	32.33	2.45
NTPC	343.70	-5.18	12.10	1.49
Maruti Suzuki	13728.00	-6.35	29.40	1.63
Axis Bank	1297.60	-7.46	15.20	3.40
Dr Reddys Lab	1269.50	-10.58	25.49	0.71
Infosys	1050.80	-14.17	14.46	3.36

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 587.10 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Macrotech Developers .	1192.15	62.65	34.72	1.36
Dlf	659.60	48.13	36.98	1.73
Hdfc Amc	2737.10	46.55	41.05	2.29
Canara Bank	124.80	35.95	6.33	1.72
Bajaj Holdings	10581.00	31.09	12.03	1.88
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1791.90	28.53	29.19	3.18
Samvardmothersoninternatl	142.80	27.84	36.89	2.59
Bpcl	308.20	27.62	5.17	2.56
Varun Beverages .	481.40	27.45	50.73	2.70
Punjab Natl Bank	103.44	25.13	6.44	1.46
Bank Of Baroda	244.60	22.56	6.30	1.86
Indian Hotels Co. .	731.45	22.00	46.33	2.63
Divis Lab	6813.00	21.60	70.43	3.55
Siemens Energy India .	3438.00	20.55	93.48	1.25
Avenuesuper	4079.40	19.27	89.59	2.70
Tata Motors Cv	419.85	18.97	51.06	3.59
Pidilitind	1590.40	18.16	65.51	2.02
Cummins Inida	5542.50	17.42	65.05	3.07
Tata Power	375.50	16.62	23.45	2.57
Ltimindtree	3854.40	16.44	22.95	1.47
Union Bank	157.26	16.25	6.18	1.25
Britannia Ind	5361.50	15.88	50.90	2.59
Bosch	42225.00	15.63	44.91	1.50
Shree Cement	26295.00	15.09	54.26	1.44
Godrej Consumer	1087.40	14.37	59.77	1.79
Tata Capital	355.85	14.16	30.88	0.73
Ambuja Cements	428.15	12.88	19.36	1.09
Rural Elec	352.00	11.90	5.68	1.80
Torrent Pharma	4898.20	9.78	77.54	2.11
Jindal Steel	1029.80	9.01	31.26	1.56
Zyduslifesciences	1159.00	8.07	22.76	1.19
Hindustanaeronautics	4378.90	7.89	32.13	3.41
Siemens	3476.40	7.85	80.77	1.26
Gail (India)	170.20	7.59	14.76	1.88
Abb India	6820.00	7.46	91.46	1.47
Indian Oilcorp	138.26	6.90	4.47	2.12
Cg Power & Ind Sol	910.90	5.63	119.88	2.56
Hyundai Motor India .	1926.20	3.89	28.82	1.13
Indian Railway Finance Corp	88.12	3.65	16.43	0.73
Power Finance	404.10	2.13	3.97	2.41
Adani Power .	216.32	-1.95	32.16	3.68
Hindus Zinc	528.50	-2.54	16.14	1.04
Vedanta	271.35	-4.72	6.69	1.89
Muthootfin	3057.40	-8.14	11.57	1.34
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3626.10	-9.36	54.06	3.49
Mazagoan Dock	2372.80	-17.34	34.73	0.74
Adanigreenenergy	1486.60	-17.69	123.24	2.04
United Spirits .	1381.20	-23.89	53.81	1.67
Adani Energy Solutions .	1618.50	-35.61	81.26	2.18
Solar Industries	17380.00	-42.19	90.56	1.74

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Cognizant commits to scale its Frontier business

Chennai: Cognizant said it was committing to scale its 'Frontier-certified workforce', the human and operational infrastructure enterprises need to convert AI capability into measurable business results. The first cohort will be Frontier-assessed and deployment-ready by the fourth quarter of 2026, the company said. OUR BUREAU

DBS Bank India's FY26 net profit up 49% at ₹1,020 cr

Mumbai: DBS Bank India Ltd, the wholly-owned subsidiary of DBS Bank Ltd, reported a 49 per cent year-on-year in FY26 net profit at ₹1,020 crore against ₹684.56 crore in FY25. The bank's capital adequacy ratio stood at 19.7 per cent, supported by a ₹1,600 crore capital infusion in March 2026, per its statement. OUR BUREAU

SFBs pitch for level playing field in co-lending to rebalance portfolio

CHANGING LANDSCAPE. They argue that their inclusion would enhance credit delivery, operational efficiency

K Ram Kumar
Mahesh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

Small finance banks (SFBs) are making a fresh push for being allowed to participate in co-lending arrangements with banks and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) so that they can rebalance their loan portfolio amid the central bank relaxing priority sector lending (PSL) target for them.

Currently, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) allows lenders such as commercial banks, all-India financial institutions, and NBFCs (including housing finance companies) to enter into co-lending arrangements (CLAs).

However, within the commercial banks category, small finance banks, local area banks and regional rural banks are excluded.

"Co-lending is one area where I believe the framework should evolve. Today, universal banks and NBFCs can co-lend, but SFBs are not part of that ecosystem," said Baskar Babu R, MD & CEO, Suryoday Small Finance Bank and Chairman, Association of SFBs of India (ASFBI).

MORE EFFICIENT

He observed that extending the CLA facility to SFBs would strengthen credit delivery, improve capital efficiency and enable partnerships that leverage the strengths of respective lenders without compromising customer relationships.

Babu emphasised that the biggest advantage would be the ability to enter specialised lending segments without having to build entirely new businesses from scratch.

"Gold loans are a case in point. Rather than investing heavily in creating a nationwide gold loan franchise, an SFB could partner with an NBFC that already has deep expertise, trained personnel and an extensive branch network. The bank would contribute its low-cost funding and balance sheet, while the NBFC would originate and service customers," he said.

POLICY RELIEF. The RBI had lowered the PSL target for SFBs with effect from April 1, helping them diversify their portfolio into secured lending business

The aforementioned logic also applies to consumer durable finance and other *niche* retail lending segments where specialist lenders have already built scale.

The RBI had lowered the PSL target for SFBs with effect from April 01, 2026, reducing the overall target from 75 per cent to 60 per cent of their adjusted net bank credit or credit equivalent of off-balance sheet exposures, whichever is higher. This was aimed at helping SFBs diversify their portfolio into secured lending business amid asset quality issues in the unsecured microfinance lending business.

Beyond partnerships with NBFCs, SFBs are also urging the RBI to consider allowing co-lending between banks.

The ASFBI Chairman said such a co-lending framework could simplify lending for customers while lowering operating costs. For instance, if a customer requires a ₹2 lakh microfinance loan but an SFB is comfortable lending only ₹1 lakh under its internal risk framework, another bank could fund the remaining amount under a single co-lending arrangement instead of forcing the borrower to approach multiple institutions.

"One lender may have a lower cost of funds while another has superior distribution. Both institutions benefit, and so does the customer," Babu said.

Bankers want the CLA framework to work in both directions — allowing SFBs to originate loans for larger banks while also participating in loans sourced by other institutions.

'Foreign financial data to be part of tax statements'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has permitted foreign financial information received under tax treaties (DTAAs) to be reflected in the assessees' Annual Information Statement (AIS) and Form 26AS.

This means overseas financial information will now show up in the tax records of an assessee.

Tax authorities can better match foreign income with the ITR. This will also help the assessees to disclose overseas income and assets correctly.

In two orders, CBDT authorises uploading of information received under AEOI (automatic exchange of information) framework under respective DTAAs (Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement).

Accordingly, the information received needs to be uploaded in the AIS within 90 days from the date of the end of month in which the information was received.

Amit Maheshwari, Managing Partner at AKM Global, called this move a significant step towards enhancing tax transparency and voluntary compliance.

READILY ACCESSIBLE

"By making foreign financial information readily accessible to taxpayers, the initiative not only enables individuals to reconcile and accurately report their overseas income and assets but also strengthens the Income Tax Department's data-driven compliance framework," he said.

According to Ashish Mehta, Partner at Khaitan & Co, the two orders create a framework for reflecting information received under the automatic exchange of information mechanism in statements easily accessible

This means overseas financial information will now show up in the tax records of an assessee

by taxpayers. "In practical terms, taxpayers should expect greater visibility of foreign account and related information already available with the tax department, making timely reconciliation and accurate disclosure even more important," he said.

WORD OF ADVICE

Experts also have word of advice for taxpayers. "Taxpayers with foreign bank accounts, investments, or other reportable financial assets should proactively review their AIS and Form 26AS and ensure that the corresponding disclosures are appropriately made in their income tax returns to mitigate the risk of future scrutiny," Maheswari said.

Mehta added that given the serious consequences of non-reporting offshore income and assets, this move should encourage better voluntary compliance.

"The move is also timely in the context of the recently-announced disclosure scheme under the Black Money Act and could support greater voluntary participation once the scheme is operationalised," he added.

India questions WTO e-comm deal, seeks clarity on legal authority of DG

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In an important intervention at the World Trade Organisation (WTO), India has questioned the institutional arrangements supporting a proposed e-commerce agreement between a group of member countries and the legal basis for the WTO Director-General (DG) and Secretariat to facilitate its implementation despite the pact lacking the consensus required for incorporation into the WTO framework.

In a communication circulated to WTO members on July 8, India posed a series of questions on the interim arrangements adopted by 66 countries to bring into force the Electronic Commerce Agreement (ECA).

The move follows the declaration issued by participating countries at the WTO's 14th Ministerial Conference in March this year setting out interim arrangements for the agreement.

On June 10, WTO Director-General Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala circulated the text of the ECA to WTO members.

The communication also questions the Director-General's role as depositary of the agreement. India pointed out that the Marrakesh Agreement provides for the Director-General to act as depositary only for WTO agreements and Annex 4 plurilateral agreements.

TRANSPARENCY CALL

Since the ECA has not been added to Annex 4, India has sought clarification on the legal authority under which the DG is receiving instruments of acceptance for the agreement.

New Delhi has also questioned the use of WTO Secretariat resources to service the pact.

Under the interim arrangements, the Secretariat would support the agreement's institutional functions, including its dispute settlement mechanism. The arrangement also envisages using the WTO's roster of arbitrators unless parties decide otherwise, while the DG would notify disputing parties of the selection of arbitrators. It also establishes an E-Commerce Committee that would report annually to the WTO General Council.

India noted that proposals to incorporate the agreement into Annex 4 of the Marrakesh Agreement establishing the WTO had failed to secure consensus in the General Council on two occasions, in February and December 2025.

"In the absence of consensus, we would like to understand the institutional basis on which the interim arrangements are operating," the submission said.

"India is right in challenging the DG and proponents of the Interim Arrangements for the Agreement on Electronic Commerce. Left unchecked, a handful of countries and the DG will increasingly feel emboldened in departing from the WTO rule book and bending in favour of the rich and powerful members of the WTO. India should make efforts to get more countries to its corner on this issue," trade expert Abhijit Das told *businessline*.

India has also sought explanations on the legal basis for deploying WTO personnel, administrative resources and dispute settlement infrastructure for an agreement that has not been adopted by the full WTO membership.

FSSAI sends notices to alchobev players over violation of regulations for added flavours

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Continuing with its crackdown on food business operators for violations of food safety norms, The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has issued a set of fresh notices to leading alcoholic beverage players for alleged non-compliance of regulatory provisions related to added flavours.

The regulator has also raised concerns about misleading claims regarding the maturing or blend age of alchobev products.

The FSSAI did not specify the names of the players who had been sent notices. However, sources said notices had been sent to leading alchobev players that hold central licences selling products in segments, especially in rum and whiskey.

NOTICES ISSUED

In a social media post, FSSAI said that notice had been issued to "Food Business Operators engaged in the manufacturing of alcoholic beverages, licensed under the FSS Act, 2006, for violating the provisions stipulated under the Food Safety and Standards (Alcoholic Beverages) Regulations, 2018."

One of the key concerns raised by the food regulator includes the prohibited use of added flavours in these products. "Certain manufacturers are blending added flavours that mimic a product's natural profile in products such as rum, brandy, gin, malt or grain whisky, wine and beer. This directly contravenes the regulation stating that these products must exclusively possess their true, natural characteristic taste and aroma," it said.

In its post, FSSAI said that some alchobev players had also been found to make "unauthorised age claims" with regard to the maturing or ageing process of the products. "FBOs are making unauthorised age claims using words, synonyms, or indirect expressions denoting age without strictly adhering to Regulation 1.3.7 of the FSS (Alcoholic Beverages) Regulations, 2018. Products carrying the word "aged" or associated age claims have failed to ensure that the declared age refers strictly to the youngest spirit utilised in the blend," it added.

FSSAI said these concerned companies have been directed to ensure compliance and submit an explanation as to why action should not be initiated under the provisions of the FSS Act, 2006.

HC enforces foreign arbitral awards in Vedanta-Ravva Oil case

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Delhi High Court has upheld two foreign arbitral awards of around $99 million in favour of Vedanta and Singapore-based Ravva Oil Company in a long-standing dispute related to the production sharing contract (PSC) of Ravva oilfield in the Krishna Godavari basin. A single judge Bench of Justice Jasmeet Singh, on July 1, allowed the enforcement petition filed by Vedanta and Ravva Oil under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act. The Bench directed the government to release the bank guarantees furnished by the companies within eight weeks. "The respondent's objections... are dismissed. Resultantly, the declaratory prayer made by the petitioners (Vedanta and Ravva Oil)... is allowed. Consequently, pending applications, if any, are disposed of. The bank guarantees submitted by the petitioner(s) shall be released, not later than 8 weeks from pronouncement of this judgment," the court order said.

The court also said that objections raised by the Government have already been decided by the Supreme Court in the *Union of India vs Vedanta case* (2020). The findings in the judgment are binding, and the court cannot re-look or revisit the same.

Banks seek global ratings to tap foreign funding

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Indian banks are increasingly seeking international credit ratings as they prepare to tap overseas funding markets and attract foreign-currency deposits, particularly through FCNR (B)-linked fund-raising programmes.

The latest entrant is Federal Bank, which on Wednesday received its first-ever international issuer credit ratings from S&P Global Ratings — BBB-/Stable for the long term and A-3 for the short term.

The development comes amid a broader trend among Indian lenders looking to shore up foreign-currency liabilities as credit demand rises. YES Bank also secured a fresh international rating from S&P Global Ratings, which assigned the lender a BB+/Stable long-term issuer credit rating and a B short-term rating.

S&P cited improving asset quality and strategic support from shareholder SMBC as key factors underpinning the rating. BoB is planning to raise up to $1 billion through the issuance of senior unsecured notes.

Soybean area may rise 5-7% on higher rates

PRICE FACTOR. Farmers, who had shifted to maize last year, are returning this kharif season, says SOPA

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

As soybean prices continue to trade well above the minimum support price (MSP), farmers in Central India's key producing States are expanding acreage under the oilseed this kharif, with the Soybean Processors Association of India (SOPA) expecting sowing to increase by 5-7 per cent over last year.

Sowing is nearly complete across the major growing regions, with some farmers who shifted to maize last year returning to soybean, attracted by better price realisations.

AT A PREMIUM. Prices in Madhya Pradesh, a key grower, are ruling at ₹6,700-6,900 a quintal, well above the MSP of ₹5,708 for the 2026-27 marketing season

FARMERS SWITCH BACK

"Based on our field assessment, soybean sowing has been completed in about 80-90 per cent of the targeted area across soybean-growing States. We expect acreage to increase by 5-7 per cent over last year as farmers are showing preference for soybean across all major producing States," said DN Pathak, Executive Director, SOPA.

Soybean acreage stood at 114 lakh hectares (lh) last year, according to SOPA.

Prices in Madhya Pradesh are ruling at ₹6,700-6,900 a quintal, well above the MSP of ₹5,708 a quintal for the 2026-27 marketing season, Pathak said. Although sowing was delayed by the late onset of the South-West monsoon, it gathered pace with improved rainfall.

As of July 8, SOPA estimated soybean acreage at 100.31 lh, well above the Agriculture Ministry's estimate of 57.92 lh. He attributed the gap to a 7-10-day lag in official reporting.

In Madhya Pradesh, SOPA estimated soybean acreage at 44.25 lh against the government's 25.96 lh. In Maharashtra, it pegged acreage at 40.25 lh compared with the official 23.58 lh, while Rajasthan was estimated at 7.98 lh against 4.94 lh.

CROP CONDITION

SOPA said sowing had been completed in about 90 per cent of the targeted area in Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, while Maharashtra has covered 80-90 per cent.

"About 1-2 per cent of the sown area has been re-sown because of poor or failed germination in some pockets following uneven rainfall," Pathak said.

The crop is largely in the vegetative stage and its condition is normal to satisfactory across major producing regions. Farmers are carrying out weed management through herbicides as well as manual operations, including *kolpa* and *dora*, depending on local conditions.

SOPA said the production outlook would depend on the distribution and adequacy of rainfall over the next three months.

"If weather conditions remain favourable, the crop has the potential to deliver better productivity and a larger harvest than last season," it said.

June ranks world's 2nd hottest on record

Srikrishnan PC
Chennai

Globally, June 2026 was the second warmest June on record, with ocean temperatures reaching an all-time high, according to the Copernicus Climate Change Service (C3S), implemented by the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF).

It was also the hottest June on record in Western Europe, with extreme heatwaves, worsening drought, wildfires and warming seas highlighting the increasing risks of a rapidly heating planet, partly driven by the intensifying El Nino conditions.

The monthly average sea surface temperature (SST) for the extra-polar ocean (60°S–60°N) was the highest on record for June and was only 0.01°C above the previous record set in June 2024, in part reflecting the development of strong El Nino conditions in the equatorial Pacific.

EUROPE BAKED

The heatwave that swept across much of Europe in the second half of June followed just weeks after a particularly severe heatwave in May.

The June heatwave shattered monthly and all-time temperature records in several countries in Europe, with significant health impacts, including heat-related deaths.

Widespread dryness across Europe and extreme heat contributed to wildfire activity, especially in the Iberian Peninsula and southern France, and increased the risk of drought in parts of eastern Europe.

The June heatwave followed a period of increasingly dry soils across western and central Europe, intensifying drought conditions that began to form during the May heatwave.

For June 2026, the European land average temperature was 19.14°C, 1.78°C above the 1991-2020 average for the month, the second warmest on record for the continent (after June 2019).

Western Europe, the area most impacted by the heatwave, recorded its warmest June on record, with an average temperature of 20.74°C, 3.05°C above the 1991-2020 average for June, beating the previous record set in June 2025.

Samantha Burgess, Strategic Lead for Climate at ECMWF, said: "June 2026 underscored how profoundly the climate is changing.

Western Europe recorded its warmest June on record and continued record warmth in the global ocean. Together, these records reflect a climate system continuing to accumulate heat.

The result is increasingly intense heatwaves, a persistently warm ocean and growing risks for people, ecosystems and infrastructure across Europe and beyond."

RISING MERCURY

June 2026 was the second warmest June on record in the ERA5 dataset, with a global average surface air temperature of 16.54°C, 0.56°C above the 1991-2020 average for the month and second only to June 2024 and 1.39°C warmer than the estimated pre-industrial (1850-1900) average.

The average sea surface temperature (SST) over the extra-polar oceans (60°S-60°N) in June 2026 was a record 20.86°C, slightly above the previous June record of 20.85°C set in 2024.

El Nino conditions continued with SSTs remaining high over much of the tropical Pacific and are expected to develop rapidly over the next few months, the report added.

QUICKLY.

Crude oil up as US-Iran conflict re-escalates

Crude oil prices rose on Thursday as markets assessed the escalating conflict between the US and Iran and its potential impact on efforts to end the war and fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz. Brent crude futures were up 53 cents to $78.55 a barrel by 1148 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate crude futures gained 39 cents to $73.91. Brent and WTI crude futures hit their highest levels since June 22 on Wednesday. A fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas supplies traversed the Strait of Hormuz prior to the Iran war, which began at the end of February. REUTERS

UPL launches herbicide for rice

Mangaluru: UPL Sustainable Agri Solutions, a crop protection and agri business company, has launched 'Ricebeaux', a smart herbicide designed for modern rice farming. A media statement said 'Ricebeaux', which is a smart, broad-spectrum, systemic, early post-emergence herbicide, combines two proven active ingredients 'Propanil' and 'Penoxsulam' with different modes of action. This combination delivers strong and reliable weed control across key weed flora of grasses and sedges. OUR BUREAU

Reservoir levels, fresh 'low' ease monsoon fears

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon rain belt may be shifting away from Central and Western India, but reservoir levels, kharif sowing prospects and the likelihood of another Bay of Bengal low suggest there is little reason for alarm.

Live storage in 166 major reservoirs monitored by the Central Water Commission, as on July 9, is 59.443 billion cubic metres (BCM) against 93.587 BCM during the corresponding period last year.

FRESH LOW

KJ Ramesh, meteorologist and former Director-General of the India Meteorological Department (IMD), told *businessline* that another low-pressure area is likely to form over the north Bay of Bengal within the next 5-6 days which should trigger widespread rainfall over Eastern and Central India.

More importantly, its formation would indicate that the broader ocean-atmosphere conditions remain favourable for sustaining the monsoon, Ramesh said.

Warming of the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal, reinforced by conditions over the western Pacific, is creating an environment conducive to a positive Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD).

A positive IOD has historically supported the monsoon and, if it develops this season, could offset much of the impact of June's rainfall deficit.

> **Formation of the next 'low'** would signal that larger ocean-atmosphere background remains favourable for expected monsoon-salvaging positive IOD

RESERVOIRS MATTER

Ramesh argued that rainfall departures alone provide an incomplete picture of the monsoon.

"True manifestation of the monsoon is on the ground. People tend to look at percentages and jump to conclusions. Instead, look at reservoir storage and rain-fed crop acreages," he said.

Even where June rainfall had been deficient, farmers could switch to short-duration crop varieties, reducing the impact of delayed rain.

He said the July 1-mid-August period, the main sowing window for the rain-fed kharif crops, will provide the clearest indication of how the season unfolds.

BREAK PHASE

DS Pai, former head of Climate Research and Services at the IMD, said a typical monsoon break lasts 5-7 days. Whether the current lull develops into a full-fledged break would become clearer over the next few days, especially if rainfall weakens further over the West Coast and Central India.

The evolution of the next 'low' will determine whether rainfall revives quickly or the dry spell persists.

MODEST DEFICIT

Ramesh said India may still end the season with a modest rainfall deficit.

The coming fortnight will be crucial — not because of the all-India rainfall tally, but because it will determine reservoir recharge, the pace of kharif sowing and whether the monsoon recovery gathers momentum.

Investments in gold ETFs turn negative in Q2 as investors press exit button

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Physically backed gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) posted net outflows of $4.27 billion in the second quarter, reversing inflows of $12.36 billion in the previous quarter, with more than half the redemptions occurring in June, World Gold Council (WGC) data showed. Assets under management fell to $526.3 billion from $607.1 billion.

Inflows into gold ETFs increased in the first quarter in sync with the precious metal soaring to a record high of $5,608 an ounce. Outflows zoomed in the second quarter as gold dropped below $4,000 in June amid fears of fallout from the US war with Iran.

The glitter is off

	Q1 2026	Q2 2026
Assets under management ($b)	607.1	526.3
Fund flows ($b)	-12.36	-4.27
Holdings (tonnes)	4,091.80	4,047

Source: World Gold Council

VOLATILITY TO PERSIST

Colin Shah, MD, Kama Jewelry, said bouts of volatility were being witnessed in asset classes due to movements in global interest rates and currency markets influenced by multiple factors.

"In the near term, the trend is likely to remain volatile as markets are rapidly recalibrating their risk appetite based on real-time developments," he said.

Even in the first quarter, exits by investors were $41.77 billion against inflows of $54.13 billion. In the second quarter, outflows from ETFs were $30.01 billion, while inflows were $25.74 billion.

US TOPS EXITS

Shah said though ETFs had gained favour due to convenience and lower entry cost, physical gold, currently witnessing weak demand, would continue to compete closely with ETF variants.

In the second quarter, demand dropped by 40.8 tonnes, as holdings slipped to 4,047 tonnes. US investors continued to top exits from gold ETFs, taking away $5.6 billion in the second quarter. Chinese inventors encashed $2.9 billion, while Indian investments remained positive at $665 million.

Year-to-date, US investors have taken out $7.87 billion and the French $551 million. Investments by the Chinese continue to be positive at $5.58 billion, while Indian inflows are $3.89 billion.

DOWN 6% YTD

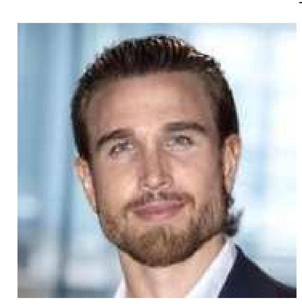
Gold, which was over $4,150 an ounce during the weekend, was quoted at $4,060 an ounce at 0900 hours IST. The yellow metal has shed over 1 per cent this week on concerns over renewed conflict in West Asia. The precious metal has declined 6 per cent year-to-date.

Colombian coffee chain Libertario brews India expansion plan, bets on premium coffee culture

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Colombian specialty coffee chain Libertario, which entered the Indian market last year, is expanding its operations, betting on rising consumer interest in premium and specialty coffees. The company plans to open four more cafés in the Delhi-NCR region this year before expanding into Mumbai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru in early 2027.

Founded in 2015, Libertario was created by a Colombian coffee-producing family to promote an experience-led specialty coffee culture, moving beyond the conventional 'grab-and-go' café model. "We have been coffee farmers, exporters and hospitality operators for many years before launching Libertario. We saw a gap for a quality-first, hospitality-driven coffee experience and built the brand around that," said Miguel Villaquiran, Co-founder and India CEO of Libertario.



Miguel Villaquiran, Co-founder and India CEO of Libertario

The company now operates across six countries — Colombia, Chile, Costa Rica, Mexico, the US and India — and has businesses spanning cafés, B2B coffee supplies and e-commerce. Unlike many international coffee brands, Libertario follows a localisation strategy by sourcing most of its beans from the markets where it operates in while showcasing select Colombian and other international specialty coffees. Around 70-80 per cent of the coffee served in Colombia, Mexico, Costa Rica and India is locally sourced.

MAINTAINING A MIX

"In India, three of our five coffee profiles are Indian-origin coffees. We always maintain a mix of local and international specialty coffees to deliver the best flavour experience while supporting regional coffee growers," Villaquiran said.

The company has also begun promoting Indian specialty coffees globally. It recently showcased Indian coffees at exhibitions organised by the Colombian government in the UAE and Colombia, receiving encouraging response from international buyers. "Consumers in Colombia were excited to try Indian coffees because they are something different, just as Indian consumers are curious about Colombian coffees. Specialty coffee consumers are increasingly looking for unique origins and flavour profiles," he said.

After partnering with two large Indian coffee estates during its first year of operations, Libertario plans to expand its sourcing network by working with more growers this year. He said the growing curiosity among Indian consumers for Colombian specialty coffees has strengthened the company's confidence in the market.

Agri-Next to support 150 start-ups for tech-driven innovations

Our Bureau
Kochi

In a major push for technology-led transformation of agriculture, the Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) has launched Agri-Next, a ₹38 crore programme to support 150 agritech start-ups under the World Bank-assisted Kerala Climate Resilient Agri-Value Chain Modernisation (KERA) Project, implemented by the State Agriculture Department.

The initiative seeks to bridge the gap between innovation and farming by enabling start-ups to deploy technologies directly on farms.

FINANCIAL AID

It aims to boost productivity, lower cultivation costs, promote climate-resilient practices, strengthen market linkages and enhance farmers' incomes through technology-driven solutions.

Selected start-ups will receive financial assistance of up to ₹25 lakh, along with mentoring, incubation support, access to farmer networks and opportunities for field demonstrations.

The programme is designed to help start-ups validate and scale innovations in collaboration with farmers and agricultural institutions.

FOCUS AREAS

Billed as one of the country's largest collaborative agritech initiatives, Agri-Next is open to start-ups working in areas such as precision farming, drones, artificial intelligence, smart irrigation, farm mechanisation, crop protection, post-harvest management, value addition, agritech-fintech and climate-smart agriculture. The selected technologies will be deployed through farmer producer organisations (FPOs), agricultural institutions and field-level agencies, which will allow start-ups to validate their solutions under real farm conditions, while demonstrating their commercial viability.

KSUM officials said the programme marks a shift towards demand-driven agricultural innovation by encouraging start-ups to develop solutions tailored to farmers' needs.

Open to agritech startups across India, the initiative aims to build a sustainable, technology-driven agricultural ecosystem while strengthening Kerala's rural economy.

Applications and programme details are available on https://agrinext.startupmission.in

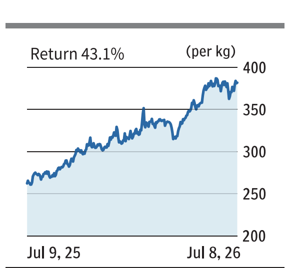
Go long on zinc futures with stop-loss at ₹360

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures (₹374/kg) have been steadily rallying over the past two weeks. The prevailing price action indicates strong uptrend, and hence the likelihood for further rally is high.

COMMODITY CALL.

The July futures rebounded on the back of the support at ₹350 and early this week, they surpassed a trendline resistance at ₹367. The contract has now moved above the hurdle at ₹372 and also, the price is above both the 21- and 50-day moving averages. Given the current chart set up, we expect zinc futures to see another upswing, potentially lifting the price to ₹390 in the near-term. A breakout of ₹390 could lead to a rally to ₹400.



On the other hand, if the contract declines from ₹374, it could find support between ₹367 and ₹363. A breach of ₹363 could trigger a decline to ₹357 and possibly to ₹350.

Nevertheless, as it stands, the bulls are having an edge over the bears and the probability for a rally is high.

TRADE STRATEGY

Buy zinc futures at ₹370 with a stop-loss at ₹360. When the price rises to ₹382, revise the stop-loss to ₹375. Book profits at ₹390.

Maize prices likely to rule at ₹2,400 a quintal, says TNAU

Gayathri G
Chennai

Farmgate prices of good-quality maize (corn) are likely to hover around ₹2,200-2,400 per quintal during the harvest season in October-November, according to the Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU).

Based on an analysis of farmgate prices at the Udumalpet Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee (APMC) yard over the past 15 years, TNAU's Centre for Agricultural and Rural Development Studies (CARDS) — under its Price Forecasting Scheme — has advised farmers in Tamil Nadu to make informed sowing decisions.

The projected price is broadly in line with the minimum support price of ₹2,410/quintal announced by the Centre for the 2026-27 kharif marketing season.

Per the third Advance Estimates of the Union Agriculture Ministry, maize will be cultivated on about 10.74 million hectares, with production estimated at 55.1 million tonnes (mt).

MAJOR PRODUCER

TNAU, in a press release, said the India Meteorological Department had forecast below-normal rainfall during the current South-West monsoon due to the El Nino phenomenon, which could affect maize output production in key maize-growing States.

However, it noted that these climate-induced supply risks, coupled with last year's bumper harvest, were being offset by the West Asian crisis and rising fuel costs, which were disrupting maize exports and domestic trade.

Tamil Nadu is among the country's major maize-producing States, with production of about 3.3 mt from 0.54 million hectares. Salem, Namakkal, Dindigul, Perambalur, Ariyalur, Villupuram and Tiruppur are the major producing districts.

The State meets only about 50 per cent of its domestic maize requirement, with the rest sourced from other States. A deficient monsoon could, therefore, make prices highly volatile, TNAU said.

QUICKLY.

Premier Energies opens 5.6 GW solar module plant

New Delhi: Premier Energies on Thursday commissioned a 5.6 GW solar module facility in Telangana as part of the company's ₹12,500 crore capex plan to build capabilities and foray into new business segments. It also performed a ground-breaking ceremony for its 6 GWh battery energy storage system (BESS) facility and 18,000 tonnes per annum aluminium frames facility, it said in a statement. PTI

Rajesh Power bags ₹653 crore PGVCL orders

Ahmedabad: Rajesh Power Services Ltd said it has secured turnkey orders worth ₹653.12 crore from Paschim Gujarat Vij Company Ltd (PGVCL) for underground power distribution projects across the State. It involves the conversion of existing 11 kV high-tension and low-tension overhead power lines into an underground cable network with a ring main system, along with GIS mapping and asset tagging. OUR BUREAU

Fossil fuel share in India's energy mix at record low in 2025: Energy Institute

SOFTENING GROWTH. Weather, renewable energy growth led to fossil fuel demand stagnating

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

ENERGY EQUATION. According to the Energy Institute's Statistical Review of World Energy dataset, coal was the main source of energy (59 %) in India in 2025, followed by oil (28%) REUTERS

Even as fossil fuels dominate India's total energy supply, with coal leading the pack, the last calendar year marked the lowest share of hydrocarbons in the consumption mix, according to the Statistical Review of World Energy.

The Energy Institute's review said coal was the main source of energy (59 per cent) in India in 2025, followed by oil (28 per cent). In contrast to historical trends, there was no overall growth in fossil fuel consumption, with gas consumption falling by 5.9 per cent, coal consumption growing by just 0.6 per cent, and oil by 0.3 per cent.

Fossil fuel consumption still dominates in India, making up 93 per cent of total energy supply, although 2025 marked its lowest market share since the dataset came online in 1965, it added.

MILD WEATHER

The cause of this was a mixture of weather-driven and structural effects. The largest factor was milder temperatures during the monsoon season, which substantially reduced cooling demand, and therefore electricity demand growth, the review said.

"Alongside this, India set new records for wind and solar generation growth, while good hydro conditions further boosted renewables' output. India's behind-the-meter solar capacity increased by 40 per cent y-o-y to reach 43.6 GW, which was the largest increase seen anywhere outside China in 2025," it noted.

These factors combined led to a 3 per cent fall in coal generation and a 15 per cent fall in gas generation. Lack of transmission infrastructure prevented further integration of renewables, following rapid increases in capacity in the last five years, the review said.

IMPORT RELIANCE

In 2025, gas production fell by 1.1 billion m^3 (3.5 per cent), and gas imports fell by 3 billion m^3 (7.9 per cent), reflecting lower gas demand.

"India remained a major importer of gas, with 53 per cent of gas requirement met by imports in 2025, 60 per cent of which came from Qatar and the United Arab Emirates (UAE)," the review highlighted.

In the absence of significant domestic oil reserves, India imported 90 per cent of its crude oil. Russia was India's largest supplier of crude oil, making up a third of its imports, while a further 48 per cent came from West Asia. In contrast, India's significant refining capacity made it a net exporter of refined oil products, with Europe and other Asia-Pacific countries the largest destinations. Domestic oil production fell by more than 1 per cent in 2025, it added.

IIT-Madras to help TNEB modernise operations

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu Electricity Board (TNEB) has partnered with IIT-Madras for technology and R&D support to modernise its operations.

An MoU was signed to work together in areas such as power generation, transmission, distribution, infra upgrades, efficiency improvements, and the promotion of Research and Development. The partnership will also see IIT help TNEB in the implementation of artificial intelligence, machine learning, data analytics, digital tech and data-driven decision-making, the Power Ministry said in a statement.

On the partnership, Tamil Nadu Electricity Minister CTR Nirmalkumar said TNEB needs sound R&D and technology support. "TNEB never had a standalone R&D team; so we have now formed a new team, and will be working with IIT Madras."

PRIORITY AREAS

"A team of experts from IIT-Madras will work with senior engineers of the TNEB in the office here," he said.

Some short-term priority areas will be evaluation of existing processes and policies and to look into the efficiency of thermal power plants. "Be it rooftop solar programmes or charging stations or load flow study or any other activity, they will support us with advisory on all areas," he added. "This will be an ongoing process, but we have internally set specific targets for each task and will track it," he said.

IIT-Madras Director V Kamakoti said he is confident that Tamil Nadu is capable of becoming an energy surplus State with sufficient help from latest technologies. "Cybersecurity of our grid systems will also be a focus," he said.

The MoU also enables joint efforts in areas such as real-time grid monitoring, centralised data centres, centralised billing systems, integration of renewable energy, and battery energy storage systems, and aid specialised skill development and training for TNEB officials.

TN CM to lay foundation stone for ₹1,700-cr Kothari Footwear plant today

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Joseph Vijay will lay the foundation stone for Kothari Footwear's new manufacturing unit in Karur on Friday.

The plant, to be established with an investment of ₹1,700 crore, is expected to create opportunities for 13,500 people, a statement from Karur's public relations office read.

The facility is being built as a joint venture between the Evervan Group and Kothari Industrial Corporation to supply footwear for German sportswear giant Adidas. It is expected to have an annual capacity of 40 million pairs.

FIRST FACILITY

This is the first major manufacturing facility that the Chief Minister will lay the foundation stone for, after his TVK government came to power in Tamil Nadu.

The Chief Minister will also distribute welfare assistance and financial aid to beneficiaries under various government schemes during his visit to Karur, the statement added.

Gujarat unveils Data Centre Policy, eyes ₹6 lakh cr investment, 7.5 GW capacity

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Betting big on India's rapidly expanding digital infrastructure opportunity, the Gujarat government on Thursday unveiled its maiden Data Centre Policy 2026-29, targeting ₹6 lakh crore of investments and the creation of 7.5 GW of data centre capacity, as it seeks to position the State as the country's leading hub for hyperscale data centres, cloud infrastructure and AI-driven digital services.

The policy offers a comprehensive package of fiscal incentives, including capital subsidy, interest subsidy, power tariff subsidy, SGST reimbursement, electricity duty reimbursement, support for desalination plants and stamp duty exemptions. It also provides non-fiscal incentives such as fast-track approvals, additional floor space index (FSI), relaxations in building norms, open access to power, assured electricity supply and water availability to accelerate project execution.

"Gujarat is the first State to bring this policy. We are confident it will attract investments of ₹6 lakh crore, create 7.5 GW of data centre capacity and generate significant employment," Chief Secretary MK Das said in Gandhinagar, where Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel unveiled the policy.

The State is also strengthening the digital infrastructure required to support large-scale investments.

GROWTH MAGNET. The policy comes as Gujarat sees a surge in interest from hyperscale operators, AI infra developers and cloud service providers

P Bharati, Secretary, Department of Science and Technology, said Gujarat will soon have two operational cable landing stations, with another project expected to be announced shortly, significantly enhancing international connectivity and making the State more attractive for global cloud and data centre operators.

ROOM FOR GROWTH

"Globally, there are around 12,000 data centres, with the United States and China accounting for nearly 70 per cent of the world's capacity. India, despite generating nearly 20 per cent of the world's data, has only about 3 per cent of global data centre capacity. This represents a tremendous opportunity," Bharati said.

Science and Technology Minister Arjun Modhwadia said India currently has only about 200 data centres, compared with nearly 5,500 in the US and around 500 in the UK. While the US has around 30 GW of installed data centre capacity, India currently has only 2-3 GW, with the pipeline expected to reach around 8 GW.

"I am happy to say that Gujarat has already received proposals equivalent to 10 GW. These are not just for data centres but cover the entire ecosystem," Modhwadia said.

POLICY BOOST

The policy comes as Gujarat has witnessed a surge in interest from hyperscale operators, AI infrastructure developers and cloud service providers, with projects announced across GIFT City, Jamnagar, Dholera and the Ahmedabad region.

The incentives under the policy will be available only for projects with a minimum approved installed IT load of 150 MW, and the overall incentive framework will apply to projects contributing towards the State's target of 7.5 GW of installed data centre capacity.

JNPA to develop 62-acre empty container yard near Nhava Sheva with RSA Global

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The 62-acre facility, on a 30-year lease, will come up 3 km from JNPA's container terminals

The Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) has entered into a licence agreement with RSA Global to develop an empty container yard (ECY) within the port premises near Nhava Sheva, aimed at improving container management and strengthening the port's logistics ecosystem.

The upcoming 62-acre facility planned on a 30-year lease, will be 3 km from JNPA's container terminals.

The facility will support the complete lifecycle management of empty containers, enabling shipping lines to optimise equipment utilisation while improving coordination between ports, terminals, container freight stations (CFSs), special economic zones (SEZs), free trade warehousing zones (FTWZs) and transport operators.

PHASED ROLLOUT

The project will be developed in three phases. Phase I, covering approximately 20 acres, is expected to become operational within 15-20 days, enabling storage and core yard operations. Phase II will add another 20 acres by January 2027, while the remaining 21.7 acres under Phase III are scheduled for completion by May 2027.

The ECY will introduce advanced technologies in phases, including gate automation, AI-enabled CCTV surveillance, a yard management system (YMS), intelligent bay allocation systems, driver utility facilities and 'Container Eye' technology for automated maintenance and repair processes.

The facility will also integrate automation solutions such as automated storage and retrieval systems (ASRS), electric overhead travelling systems (EOTS), optical character recognition systems (OCRS) and integrated IT platforms to improve visibility, efficiency and operational control.

The facility will provide a comprehensive range of services, including empty container storage, maintenance and repair, pre-trip inspection, container survey and inspection, SOLAS weighment compliance, repositioning transportation, container fabrication and modification, and CFS transfers.

The yard will be equipped to handle multiple equipment categories, including dry containers, reefer containers, ISO tanks, out-of-gauge/project cargo equipment and collapsible containers.

It will operate 24x7 to support uninterrupted logistics movement and improve turnaround times for maritime stakeholders.

Battery materials, auto component makers draw over ₹540 crore as supply chain investment cycle accelerates

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

CAPEX SURGE. ICRA estimates that the auto component industry will invest ₹20,000-25,000 crore during FY27 REUTERS

Nearly ₹540 crore of disclosed investments announced at the start of the second quarter of FY27 underscore a growing shift in capital towards India's automotive supply chain, with investors backing battery materials, advanced manufacturing and localisation even as ICRA estimates the auto component industry will invest ₹ 20,000-25,000 crore during FY27.

Leading the investment cycle, Australian battery materials company Sicona Battery Technologies, backed by Himadri Speciality Chemical Ltd, secured up to A$ 45 million (around ₹255 crore) from the Australian Renewable Energy Agency (ARENA) to commercialise its silicon-carbon anode technology for lithium-ion batteries. Automotive component supplier JRG Automotive Industries raised ₹125 crore from Piramal Alternatives to expand manufacturing capacity, modernise factories and pursue acquisitions, while AISIN announced a ₹150-crore expansion in Punjab to localise premium transmission and powertrain components.

The investments follow Himadri's decision last month to raise its stake in US-headquartered International Battery Company (IBC) to 20.47 per cent through an additional investment of $0.66 million, strengthening its presence across the battery materials value chain.

Fresh investment is increasingly targeting battery materials, precision manufacturing, automotive electronics and other high-value components where India continues to rely on imports despite the auto component industry's ₹7.6 lakh crore turnover and ICRA's projected ₹20,000-25,000 crore capex cycle for FY27.

MATERIALS GAIN SCALE

The transactions point to a broader shift in capital allocation across India's automotive ecosystem.

Rather than flowing primarily into vehicle manufacturers, fresh investments are increasingly targeting upstream technologies and manufacturing capabilities that improve domestic value addition, accelerate localisation and position suppliers to capture rising domestic and export demand.

FRESH CAPITAL

"The fresh capital endorsement will allow us to scale our manufacturing capabilities and infrastructure to better serve our long-term OEM partners," said Pawan Goyal, Managing Director, JRG Automotive Industries.

MMA to host Platinum Jubilee AGM and Excellence Awards

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Madras Management Association (MMA) is set to celebrate its Platinum Jubilee Annual General Meeting and Awards Function on Friday in Chennai. The Platinum Jubilee celebration marks 70 years of MMA's service to management education, leadership development, industry engagement and nation-building.

As part of the occasion, MMA will launch several special initiatives, including the Platinum Jubilee MMA Awards for Managerial Excellence, the Special Platinum Jubilee Issue of *Business Mandate*, Volume 3 of *Turning Points: Management Lessons from Legends*, the Platinum Jubilee Coffee Table Book, and the Platinum Jubilee Logo. The event will also feature a special tribute to the past Presidents of MMA, in recognition of their outstanding contribution.

A major highlight of the evening will be the presentation of the prestigious 24th MMA Awards for Managerial Excellence 2026. This year's winners include ELGI Equipments Ltd, Apollo Hospitals, Indus Life Sciences Pvt Ltd, and SSN College of Engineering.

Thomas Dose, MD, BMW Group Plant, Chennai, will deliver the valedictory address and present the awards.

The Hindu Group and the *The Hindu businessline* are the media partners for the MMA Awards for Managerial Excellence.

Ladakh bets on connectivity to power tourism growth

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

STRATEGIC PASSAGE. Due for completion in 2028, the Zojila tunnel will offer all-year Kashmir-Ladakh connectivity

As Ladakh awaits two of its biggest connectivity upgrades — the Zojila tunnel and a new terminal at Leh airport — tourism stakeholders are preparing for what they believe could be a sustained expansion of the sector, with improved road and air access expected to reshape travel to the high-altitude region over the coming years.

The optimism stems from infrastructure projects that stakeholders say will address two of Ladakh's biggest constraints — seasonal road closures and limited flight capacity.

UNIMPEDED FLOW

The Zojila tunnel, expected to be completed by 2028, will provide year-round road connectivity between Kashmir and Ladakh.

Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu on Wednesday said 83 per cent of the physical work on Leh's new airport terminal had been completed.

Once operational, the terminal will be capable of handling up to 54 flights a day, more than three times the current capacity.

Norboo Wangchuk, General Secretary of the All Ladakh Hotel and Guest House Association (ALHGHA), told *businessline* that improved connectivity would be critical to ensuring the long-term growth of tourism in the region.

"Once these two crucial projects are completed, Ladakh's tourism sector will witness a major transformation," he said.

Wangchuk said all-weather road connectivity through the Zojila tunnel and increased flight capacity at Leh airport would make the region far more accessible, reduce travel uncertainties and attract more domestic as well as international tourists.

TOURIST ARRIVALS UP

Ladakh witnessed a strong recovery in tourist arrivals this year. Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena said in a post on X: "Foreign tourist arrivals reached 6,680 in June, a 100 per cent increase over 3,349 in the same month last year."

Iswarya Fertility raises over ₹350 cr from OrbiMed Asia

Our Bureau
Chennai

Chennai-based Iswarya Fertility Center has announced a growth investment of more than ₹350 crore (around US$37 million) from OrbiMed Asia, a global healthcare investment firm.

Established in 1986, Iswarya has a fertility network of 85+ centres across eight States, serving more than 300,000 couples over four decades.

The investment will enable Iswarya to establish new centres in existing and underserved markets, strengthen clinical infra, invest in digital capabilities and expand its embryology talent pipeline. "We will invest in our people, technology and patient experience, ensuring that excellence remains at the heart of everything we do. We are delighted to welcome OrbiMed as our partner on this journey," Arun Muthuvel, Managing Director, Iswarya Fertility Center, said. Veda Corporate Advisors were the financial advisors to the company and its promoters.

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - JULY 10 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Emirates to deploy A380 on Delhi route from Oct

New Delhi: UAE-based airline major Emirates will introduce its flagship Airbus A380 on the Delhi-Dubai route from October 25 while expanding its premium economy offering to six destinations in India. According to the airline, the Airbus A380 will operate on flights EK512/513 in a four-class configuration. By the end of October, Emirates will offer premium economy on four daily services from Delhi, 12 weekly flights from Kolkata, 22 weekly flights from Mumbai, nine weekly flights from Ahmedabad, seven weekly flights from Bengaluru and two weekly flights from Kochi. OUR BUREAU

Adani to file affidavit this week in US court

New Delhi: Businessman Gautam Adani will file this week a sworn affidavit in a US federal court stating whether he is aware of any promise, agreement or benefit linked to the US government's decision to dismiss a criminal indictment against him. US district judge Nicholas Garaufis had directed Adani to file the affidavit by July 15 before ruling on the Justice Department's motion to dismiss the indictment with prejudice. Adani was told to state whether he is aware of any promise, offer, agreement or benefit connected to the dismissal or of any exchange made in return for the charges being dropped. PTI

Air India enters the final phase of Vihaan.AI transformation

GROWTH PATH. Airline says key objectives were achieved; fleet induction, profitability remain final milestones

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Tata Group-promoted Air India has entered the final phase of its Vihaan.AI transformation programme after achieving the initiative's core objectives, with fleet expansion, cabin retrofits, as well as profitability emerging as the remaining focus areas, the airline told *businessline*.

Responding to queries, an Air India spokesperson said Vihaan.AI was launched as a comprehensive transformation programme to strengthen the airline's foundations and position it for long-term growth.

ONGOING JOURNEY

The spokesperson said the key objectives of the programme had been substantially achieved, including the integration of the airline group, significant fleet and network expansion, enhanced customer propositions, major digital investments, and the development of new organisational capabilities.

While describing transformation as an ongoing journey, the spokesperson said the airline is now focused on scaling these gains and building on the strong foundation established through Vihaan.AI.

Speaking to *businessline*, industry sources dismissed suggestions that the transformation programme had either concluded or undergone any change in direction.

Reinforcing the airline's position on the programme's progress, sources said most of Vihaan.AI's transformation workstreams had already transitioned into business-as-usual operations.

Both confirmations come at a time when the airline has undertaken temporary rationalisation of select domestic and international services owing to continued airspace restrictions over certain regions, aircraft delivery delays and elevated operating costs.

Last week, in an internal communication to employees, Air India Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director Campbell Wilson said the easing tensions in West Asia and the moderation in international aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices could allow the airline to gradually restore some of the schedule reductions that were implemented in recent months, should the current operating environment remain stable.

According to sources, only two major elements of the programme — fleet expansion and product upgradation through the induction of new aircraft and the retrofitting of the existing fleet — have progressed more slowly than originally envisaged owing to global post-Covid supply-chain disruptions and delays, including production delays at Boeing, Airbus and seat suppliers.

"These delays have affected other airlines too, but we are now full steam ahead," sources said.

PASSENGER BASE

Besides, the airline is entering the next phase of its network strategy by concentrating operations around three major domestic hubs while expanding its presence in long and ultra-long-haul international markets.

As part of this strategy, Air India Express is expected to assume a larger role in domestic and short-haul international operations under the supervision of the Air India Management Committee.

Sources said Air India will increasingly focus on point-to-point international traffic while simultaneously building a larger transit passenger base through its domestic hub-and-spoke network.

REVAMP DRIVE. An Air India spokesperson said Vihaan.AI was launched as a comprehensive transformation programme to strengthen the airline's foundations

Google launches tools to monetise AI mode

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Beyond AI overviews, Google is now experimenting with new monetisation models in the AI mode experience that involves live conversations with users, as per Dan Taylor, Vice-President, Global Ads, Google, during a media briefing.

"We're reinventing ads for this new era of search to help both answer and inspire all at once," said Taylor, adding that the company has been testing ads in AI mode in the United States for a year.

The launch of new tools seeks to integrate AI directly into the ads on the search results page. The new ad formats rethink the ads look as well as the value added to the search experience, said the Vice President, arguing that "the best ads are really just answers".

NEW ERA

Earlier, in March, Taylor said advertising that appears next to, above, below or within AI Overviews monetise at the same approximate rate as traditional search result ads. The Gemini-integration into Google's ad quality stack reduced the rates of irrelevant ads by 40 per cent, he said.

The new approach seeks to prepare ads for what Google termed as "the new era of search".

Stating that search has become a deeper tool for discovery and decision-making with conversational AI, Taylor listed how 84 per cent of people in India reported faster decisions and 87 per cent cited more confident decisions when using AI mode.

"It really comes back to how consumer behaviour is changing," he said.

The assertions came during Google launch of its new AI-powered tools for Indian businesses at the Google Marketing Live 2026. Among those, the Business Agent for Leads is available in beta in India.

The Gemini-built tool puts a brand agent directly inside the ad to chat with a user and use the interaction as a lead. Similarly, YouTube BrandStack, an automated solution conceptualised and built in India deals with campaign planning, buying and measurement.

"With 86 per cent of surveyed online Indians turning to Google Search and YouTube, Indian businesses have a tremendous opportunity to meet consumers where they are — and we are enabling that with Gemini," said Roma Datta Chobey, Managing Director, Connected Consumer Commerce, Google India.

Gemini now acts as the engine for growth, moving beyond marketing automation to marketing intelligence, said Chobey. Other tools focus on driving campaign performance like AI Max for Shopping, AI Brief, Retention Only Mode in Performance Max and marketer tools like Ask Advisor.

Tata Advanced Systems, Nibe lead ₹1,600 crore UAV procurement race

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With drones dominating the modern warfare, Indian Army is in the process of acquiring different kinds of unmanned aerial vehicles through tenders to augment combat capabilities.

While Tata Advanced Systems Ltd (TASL) and Nibe Ltd have emerged as the lowest bidders in the Army's tender to procure 840 loitering munitions of 100 km range, valued around ₹1,600 crore, another tender is coming up for acquiring 36 jet-based propulsion system for UAVs, likely to be worth around ₹1,500 crore.

In both the bids, orders would be split between L-1 and L-2 to create larger diversified industry base for unmanned systems that have long endurance similar to Shaheed drones of Iran which have caught global attention.

The lowest bidder, Tata Advanced Systems, will get the larger share of the order to supply 64 per cent of the 840 loitering munitions required by the Indian Army's artillery.

ADVANCED WARFARE

TASL's advanced loitering system (ALS) is an indigenously designed, developed and manufactured loitering munition system for advanced warfare useful for the armed forces of India in both surveillance and combat scenarios.

The ALS can be equipped with different types of warheads as per the operational requirements.

Its live EO/IR feed capability with its precise targeting algorithm allows the user to view live video feed enabling him to guide the munition as required, said the company.

TASL will get a big share of the order to supply 64 per cent of the 840 loitering munitions required by the Army

With built-in multiple failsafe features, the system can be aborted after launch, recovered and made to re-attack the same or a different target.

TECHNICAL TRIALS

Nibe Defence, the second highest bidder, would get to supply 36 per cent of the Vayu Astra-1 loitering munition or suicide drones, built on an Israeli-origin platform specifically adapted from Elbit Systems' SkyStriker technology.

The system recently went through rigorous maiden technical trials and no-cost, no-commitment (NCNC) demonstrations for the Indian Army.

Sources said the Army recently opened price bids for its fast-track procurement of loitering munitions, with the TASL expected to get orders worth roughly ₹1,000 crore while remaining around ₹600 crore Nibe will get.

The Artillery Directorate is expected to induct drones from ranges between 50 km and 1,000 km in the next 12-18 months under fast-track procedures.

It's learnt that the Army is looking at procuring nearly one lakh drones for ISR and other combat duties in a phased manner over a period of time.

Novo Nordisk rolls out once-weekly basal insulin

PT Jyoti Datta
Mumbai

Novo Nordisk India is rolling out Awiqli, a weekly once basal insulin, for adults with Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes mellitus.

The product reduces the insulin regimen from once-daily to once-weekly, or 365 shots to 52.

Vikrant Shrotriya, Managing Director, Novo Nordisk India, told *businessline* that 217 patients from India were part of the global trials, and India is the seventh market in which it is being launched.

The product will be imported from Denmark and is priced ₹2,611 for a 1 ml pen (700 insulin units). With 70 units weekly, the pen lasts for 10 weeks or 2.5 months. A 3 ml pen is priced ₹7833 (2,100 insulin units).

The product is approved in the US, EU, and 13 other countries.

EXPERT OPINION

While industry-watchers point to the competitive pricing (comparable with basal

insulins in the market), doctors are watchful on factors like hypoglycaemia (dip in blood sugar), especially in people with Type 1 diabetes.

Diabetologist V Mohan, Chairman, Dr Mohan's Diabetes Specialities Centre, told *businessline* that trials had shown the once-a-week product to be a good option for people with Type II diabetes who do not want to take daily insulin.

However, clinical trial settings are controlled environments, he said, adding that it needs to be seen how the product pans out in the real world. For now, he would hold from prescribing it to people with Type 1 diabetes, who need to be careful about matching their dosages and fluctuating sugar levels.

Jeh Aerospace lines up over $50 m in capacity addition

bl.interview

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Jeh Aerospace is betting on India's growing role in global aerospace supply chains with its global manufacturing centre (GMC) model. The Hyderabad-based precision aerospace manufacturer has secured an order book exceeding $250 million and plans to invest over $50 million in the next three years. Vishal Sanghavi, Co-founder of Jeh Aerospace, spoke about his company's expansion strategy, investment roadmap, and on the industry.

Edited excerpts:

Jeh Aerospace has expanded rapidly within a short span. Where does the business stand today?

We have grown much faster than we had initially anticipated. Our confirmed order book is now in excess of $250 million, reflecting the long-term nature of aerospace manufacturing contracts. More importantly, we have earned the trust of global customers, which is the most difficult part in this industry.

We currently work with about seven customers across the US and Europe, while another five customers are in the pipeline. We manufacture more than 350,000 high-precision aerospace components, and demand continues to remain strong. The real differentiator is not winning orders but consistently delivering quality and on-time performance.

What are your investment and expansion plans over the next few years?

We have already invested more than $10 million in the business. Over the next three years, we plan to invest over $50 million, primarily towards expanding manufacturing capacity.

Our present facility occupies about 60,000 sq ft, and we have already secured another 200,000 sq ft within the same industrial park at Kothur, near Hyderabad, for expansion.

This will essentially be a brownfield expansion as we prefer leasing industrial infrastructure and investing capital in advanced manufacturing equipment rather than land and buildings.

> We have built a manufacturing base of 50 high-precision CNC machines within just one-and-a-half years, which is unusually fast for the aerospace industry
>
> **VISHAL SANGHAVI**
> Co-founder of Jeh Aerospace

How is the manufacturing capacity being scaled up?

We have built a manufacturing base of 50 high-precision CNC machines within just one-and-a-half years, which is unusually fast for the aerospace industry. We expect this to increase to more than 150 machines over the next 12-18 months.

These are advanced CNC machines sourced largely from Germany and Japan and are capable of producing aerospace components requiring sub-10 micron precision. Our products are used in aero engines, landing gear systems and other critical aircraft applications involving hard metals such as titanium and Inconel.

Your GMC model appears different from the conventional joint venture route. What makes it unique?

The aerospace industry's biggest bottleneck today is not at the aircraft manufacturer level but across tier-1 and tier-2 suppliers. Nearly 70 per cent of the value addition in an aircraft happens in these layers.

Having previously built joint ventures for Boeing, Lockheed Martin and Sikorsky, we realised that while the JV model works, it is also bureaucratic and time-consuming.

The GMC model provides global customers the benefits of manufacturing in India without the legal and operational complexities of a traditional joint venture. The manufacturing facilities remain in India, but they function as dedicated manufacturing centres for overseas customers, helping them build resilient supply chains while retaining quality and delivery standards.

How competitive is India in global aerospace manufacturing today?

The opportunity is enormous because the global aerospace industry is facing severe supply-chain constraints.

Today, companies such as Airbus and Boeing continue to struggle because their suppliers cannot ramp up production fast enough.

India offers three important advantages. First, we have access to skilled engineering talent. Second, we can manufacture globally competitive products. Third, we can deliver significant cost advantages over Western markets. Winning trust through consistent performance remains the biggest challenge.

How do you see the aerospace manufacturing industry evolving over the next five years?

Two major trends are emerging. The first is the increasing adoption of additive manufacturing, which will continue gaining importance as the technology matures. The second is a structural shift in global supply chains. Earlier, companies outsourced largely for lower costs.

Today, resilience has become equally important. Businesses want diversified supply chains instead of depending excessively on one geography. This creates a significant opportunity for India, especially as global companies seek alternatives to China.

However, India's long-term success will depend on consistently delivering world-class quality.

World Cup 10-second advertising rates soar to ₹20-25 lakh for knockout matches

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Strong demand from advertisers for the FIFA World Cup 2026 has led to the premium on 10-second advertising rates reaching ₹20-25 lakh (combining both linear and digital) during the knockout stage, as per Zee Entertainment Enterprises.

Digital advertising rates are understood to be higher than linear TV, as per sources aware of the development.

The company confirmed commitment of over 95 per cent of premium advertising inventory for FIFA World

Cup 2026 across its digital platform Zee5 and linear sports channels as the tournament enters the quarter finals stage.

Commenting on the demand, Sandeep Mehrotra, Chief Operating Officer, Advertisement Revenue, Zee Entertainment, said, "The response from advertisers has exceeded our expectations. The strong advertiser confidence we are witnessing reaffirms our broader vision of building a differentiated and sustainable sports ecosystem."

ADVERTISING RUSH

More than 22 brands across categories including automotive, technology, beverages, FMCG, healthcare, sportswear and lifestyle, fashion, e-commerce, financial services, travel and hospitality, real estate, paints, oil and energy and education have partnered with Zee so far for the coveted sports property.

Apart from advertiser participation, Zee flagged considerable fan engagement across television, digital and social platforms.

When asked about projected estimates, Ajimon Francis, Director, Brand Finance India, said this is the right time for ads to flow in larger numbers, foreseeing the rates to crescendo over the next week or so.

He argued that the momentum of advertisers was expected to really build up toward the elimination rounds (Round of 32 and Round of 16).

Ammunic Systems eyes South-East Asia expansion, focuses on loitering munitions

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Defence R&D start-up Ammunic Systems plans to focus on loitering munitions and advanced naval electronic fusing systems over the next five years, as it looks to expand its product portfolio and tap export markets.

Currently, the company has an order book of ₹15 crore and is targeting to expand into South-East Asia and West Asia, Founder and Chief Executive Officer Priyanka Singhal told *businessline*.

Singhal added that the company's current focus is on loitering munitions and gravity-drop bombs, particularly its Skanda system. She added that Ammunic is also expanding into naval warfare technologies, which it sees as an underserved segment.

"We have filed a patent for an advanced electronic fusing system designed to replace legacy mechanical fuses that are largely imported and used in underwater operations," she said.

COST-EFFECTIVE

On global expansion, Singhal said Southeast Asia and West Asia offer the most immediate opportunities, as these markets are receptive to cost-effective defence technologies and technology transfer partnerships similar to India's defence ecosystem. In contrast, she said, customers in Europe and the US generally prefer co-development models, given their more mature technological capabilities.

Priyanka Singhal, Founder and Chief Executive Officer

"Earlier, our production capacity was limited, so we prioritised domestic demand and declined export opportunities. Over the past six to seven months, however, we have expanded our production capabilities, allowing us to cater to both domestic and international markets," she said. The company has raised $1.1 million in a seed funding round co-led by India Accelerator and its multi-stage venture capital arm Finvolve.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	116.82	117.88	116.99	119.17	116.41	116.30	209.10	86.50	-	117.90
AlliedBlend	674.80	666.60	670.00	684.00	665.00	265.08	711.70	382.10	-	-
AllTimePlas	236.95	234.23	236.95	243.01	233.10	52.19	334.90	186.00	-	-
Alok Ind	12.40	12.47	12.51	12.65	12.44	3189.77	23.50	11.11	-	-
Amagi Media	573.30	575.80	570.00	585.00	548.55	392.29	592.50	310.20	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	835.10	869.50	847.65	881.20	847.00	2083.47	1057.85	670.00	-	-
Amber	7424.00	7600.50	7507.00	7704.00	7500.00	423.32	8970.00	5404.00	178	7593.45
AMBIKA COTTO	1693.10	1761.80	1702.00	1775.00	1702.00	21.21	1809.90	1100.60	14	1762.70
Ambuja Cem [2]	421.10	428.15	422.35	429.80	421.90	2408.60	625.00	394.00	27	428.65
Amines&Pla	191.52	204.61	192.39	210.70	192.39	42.99	263.79	127.00	-	-
AmirChand Ja	164.50	172.64	165.00	172.72	163.47	970.48	200.00	117.02	-	-
Amrutanjan [1]	537.90	535.55	540.70	545.70	533.55	25.22	789.95	490.00	24	535.25
Anand RathiW	2059.80	2095.60	2075.00	2120.00	2055.00	455.05	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	556.00	572.75	566.00	576.70	562.50	256.59	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	544.75	569.45	548.10	572.00	548.10	3209.12	744.10	403.00	69	569.35
Anant Raj Gl	124.27	124.43	124.50	130.39	121.75	4671.57	206.10	109.10	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	83.28	84.54	83.95	86.20	83.50	290.53	107.00	63.27	11	84.64
AngelOne	331.20	341.10	331.35	342.95	331.35	7522.85	2872.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	15.19	15.47	15.15	15.64	15.10	2817.96	172.75	12.91	-	-
AntelopusSel	823.50	794.45	829.95	854.75	791.10	158.78	933.65	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	748.45	752.00	757.95	767.95	749.10	379.82	873.50	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	451.15	455.00	444.40	457.85	427.00	187.78	681.80	372.50	-	-
Anup Engg	2135.30	2153.40	2147.90	2193.90	2135.70	18.81	2954.90	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1259.70	1267.90	1258.10	1272.60	1253.50	242.30	1415.00	1045.20	-	-
Apar Ind	13443.00	14070.00	13470.00	14150.00	13470.00	119.37	17148.00	6800.00	57	14055.80
Apcotex Ind [2]	496.95	506.40	504.00	512.00	499.20	46.80	579.20	310.15	26	505.65
Apex	383.05	388.75	381.70	400.90	381.70	105.12	514.20	202.90	31	388.20
APL Apollo [2]	1809.60	1785.90	1809.90	1817.40	1783.00	545.78	2300.90	1493.00	91	1785.90
APOLLO [1]	393.40	398.30	395.00	401.15	387.05	14168.77	466.70	162.25	123	398.60
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8753.50	8845.50	8756.50	8920.50	8756.50	571.83	8948.10	6680.00	85	8842.95
Apollo Pipes	468.20	487.70	468.20	492.00	467.20	124.49	554.00	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	439.55	439.65	438.00	446.50	436.55	634.89	540.30	365.35	15	439.35
Aptus V Hsg	277.90	279.50	276.65	282.45	274.85	516.72	364.00	193.03	-	-
Aqylon Nexus	39.80	39.71	39.00	41.00	37.81	1545.41	2247.00	37.81	-	-
Archean Chem	520.15	524.50	523.00	530.60	522.10	43.25	727.60	483.00	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	86.17	88.54	86.80	91.00	85.50	2565.08	106.20	31.43	-	-
Arih.Capital	70.04	74.62	70.04	76.30	70.04	999.32	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	108.28	109.83	108.28	111.99	108.28	138.30	178.30	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	125.85	131.94	127.08	132.50	126.12	796.94	213.69	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1697.20	1725.00	1701.20	1742.00	1701.20	17.43	1903.15	1256.10	45	1729.80
Artemis Med	263.50	268.00	263.40	269.05	263.40	189.58	297.50	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	460.50	466.40	462.70	470.00	461.00	92.38	579.05	366.60	-	466.10
Arvind Ltd	525.50	533.10	525.00	542.85	522.05	808.32	600.00	275.00	50	532.15
Asahi Ind. [1]	876.45	891.55	878.95	897.50	876.05	76.39	1072.95	775.05	68	890.40
Asahi Songwo	261.80	275.85	256.35	283.95	256.35	33.42	462.90	179.25	14	275.90
Ashapura [2]	627.35	637.10	633.90	643.40	630.00	145.20	924.70	447.00	39	636.95
Ashiana h [2]	372.40	373.80	370.40	380.95	370.40	35.78	406.00	250.60	30	374.85
Ashok Leyl [1]	156.22	155.19	157.10	158.85	155.01	17319.66	215.35	115.00	24	155.25
Ashoka [5]	125.98	127.19	126.00	127.56	124.60	446.23	214.35	101.00	18	127.00
Asian Energy	316.80	330.50	321.85	339.00	318.60	137.67	392.00	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	48.66	47.89	48.90	49.99	47.35	3490.76	79.08	47.50	-	48.17
Asian Paints [1]	2665.90	2673.80	2658.00	2722.80	2656.00	918.57	2985.50	2116.00	59	2672.50
ASK Auto.	465.50	479.95	466.00	486.90	466.00	461.89	578.50	375.30	-	-
Asso Alcohol	819.50	819.55	819.50	845.90	816.50	34.63	1277.00	660.65	-	-
ASTECFE	670.15	686.65	677.20	690.50	670.45	19.53	940.45	512.35	-	687.25
ASTERDM	779.60	807.15	780.95	817.95	779.00	1189.06	847.95	519.80	128	806.85
Astra Micro [2]	1809.30	1833.10	1809.30	1846.00	1806.00	362.90	1873.55	835.90	98	1831.10
Astral Poly [1]	1336.00	1317.10	1336.00	1348.80	1311.60	527.33	1767.95	1262.75	57	1318.25
Atal RealTe	28.28	28.53	28.28	29.11	28.28	7043.19	32.00	17.75	-	-
AtherEnergy	1200.00	1218.40	1212.00	1242.90	1191.50	5425.59	1242.90	318.60	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1652.70	1663.00	1675.00	1689.60	1652.80	59.42	2152.60	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	474.15	491.25	476.05	496.70	473.15	147.91	554.20	381.00	25	490.90
ATUL.	6306.50	6183.00	6309.50	6370.00	6159.50	36.78	7700.80	5563.00	31	6184.10
AU SFB	1038.80	1047.40	1038.80	1050.80	1035.10	1090.59	1090.40	682.50	30	1047.40
Aurionpro So	817.50	835.25	820.90	848.00	820.90	69.48	1663.15	720.10	42	836.95
Aurob Ph [1]	1557.40	1587.40	1555.00	1602.80	1550.10	803.53	1636.00	1017.00	38	1586.50
Aurum Prop	217.89	220.70	219.95	226.79	219.03	102.02	237.00	151.90	-	-
Authum Inv	501.10	507.50	501.45	515.50	500.00	112.89	3318.70	400.00	-	-
Avalon Tech	1631.20	1728.60	1651.90	1783.50	1651.20	879.95	1853.00	777.30	-	-
Avantel	182.20	179.81	183.04	186.99	178.73	3220.94	215.00	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	910.60	919.25	915.15	936.85	912.45	334.39	1592.30	614.05	23	920.50
AvenueSai	16.23	17.12	16.20	17.28	16.19	26501.64	20.50	12.92	-	-
Avro India	9.99	9.95	10.09	10.10	9.76	375.23	173.86	9.76	-	-
Awfis Space	298.20	305.85	299.95	311.00	298.90	219.30	666.10	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1309.50	1297.60	1312.90	1321.60	1292.20	5609.85	1418.30	1041.30	16	1299.00
AXISCADES [5]	1536.50	1605.90	1531.00	1613.30	1525.00	248.88	2210.00	1061.00	472	1604.15
Aye Finance	162.50	167.76	164.10	169.40	163.81	430.56	184.60	163.35	-	167.80
AYM Syntex	235.90	231.23	237.10	242.00	229.10	78.38	280.00	144.35	206	232.30
Azad Engg	2229.40	2476.10	2240.00	2491.50	2240.00	2468.48	2491.50	1360.00	-	-

B

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
BAJAJ AUTO	10164.00	10155.00	10176.00	10260.00	10112.00	191.19	10834.95	7879.45	29	10153.35
Bajaj Cons [1]	613.90	643.55	615.00	648.70	615.00	934.78	649.20	220.05	43	642.55
Bajaj Elect [2]	320.95	326.75	321.00	330.90	320.95	94.85	707.95	300.70	-	326.45
Bajaj Fin [1]	1010.40	1003.80	1000.00	1013.50	994.10	11712.52	1102.45	788.40	37	1003.30
Bajaj Finser [1]	1854.90	1895.00	1856.00	1911.90	1850.00	2049.97	2194.65	1598.15	212	1894.25
Bajaj HCare	335.15	350.10	333.20	361.95	332.60	535.56	552.60	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	17.27	17.24	17.27	17.63	17.20	4468.41	29.62	14.89	-	17.26
Bajaj Holdng	10336.00	10581.00	10392.00	10611.00	10388.00	48.07	14753.50	8597.50	46	10577.60
Bajaj HsgFin	85.99	87.59	85.95	88.10	85.85	3883.08	124.00	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	186.48	185.68	188.00	190.00	184.50	185.31	263.90	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	2196.70	2364.00	2210.00	2390.00	2210.00	1043.84	2389.00	905.15	46	2367.05
Balaji Tele. [2]	90.04	91.21	90.17	93.00	89.77	78.85	139.99	70.00	-	91.15
Balkrish Ind [2]	2167.30	2201.80	2184.90	2218.30	2152.30	247.00	2800.20	1971.50	42	2200.60
BalmerLawrie	174.70	176.61	175.60	177.25	174.91	54.61	238.00	148.35	12	176.60
BalramChini [1]	560.85	567.45	558.85	579.60	558.80	329.70	627.00	393.40	34	567.95
Balu Forge	439.80	452.10	442.50	455.60	440.10	408.32	702.90	341.05	-	-
Banaras Bead	116.82	114.15	118.02	124.00	112.55	112.43	171.90	96.80	43	114.05
Banco Prod [2]	659.60	673.20	663.75	679.80	663.20	102.94	879.60	503.00	23	672.75
Bandhan Bk	196.04	199.86	197.00	201.00	197.00	4750.46	218.35	134.30	26	199.95
Bank of Maha	80.60	82.01	81.00	82.26	80.86	12124.96	94.50	51.71	9	82.00
Bansal Wire	330.20	327.10	330.00	340.00	326.00	246.05	434.30	222.50	-	-
Bansw Synt [5]	121.69	120.77	122.72	126.74	119.52	78.00	154.60	93.20	12	120.90
BASF India	3456.80	3477.30	3469.90	3515.00	3458.00	8.46	5251.00	2906.90	36	3479.80
Bata India [5]	669.00	672.30	673.20	682.55	670.15	71.28	1287.85	605.55	52	672.80
Bayer Crop	4163.50	4120.20	4169.10	4178.40	4112.00	33.85	6539.95	4030.00	27	4119.75
BCL Ind.	33.39	33.97	33.70	34.29	33.47	327.49	49.30	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1337.40	1326.30	1337.80	1349.60	1321.00	784.73	1998.00	1090.00	116	1326.05
Belrise Inds	225.74	228.84	227.43	232.85	226.53	4000.22	252.00	102.25	-	-
BEML [5]	1776.20	1816.10	1775.00	1826.70	1769.60	226.80	2365.00	1361.10	102	1813.60
BergerPaints [1]	498.10	497.00	498.00	502.70	486.00	334.61	594.20	391.50	51	496.65
Beta Drugs	1998.00	2190.30	2008.50	2239.40	2008.50	88.06	2250.00	990.10	-	-
BF INVEST [5]	434.65	444.80	440.85	450.50	437.80	28.81	526.80	316.00	11	446.00
BF UTILI [5]	545.40	559.25	548.00	566.60	546.55	30.65	899.00	369.00	-	560.90
BFLYGANDHI	717.50	721.25	720.00	738.00	715.50	63.23	844.00	566.95	28	719.35
Bhagira.Chm	291.10	301.25	292.00	305.00	290.95	315.44	325.00	170.60	-	-
BHANSALI E [1]	96.20	101.25	96.20	103.00	96.20	813.85	118.25	75.52	14	101.04
BHARAT BIJ [5]	2641.40	2649.20	2652.00	2669.90	2635.10	14.56	3403.40	2009.45	25	2648.85
Bharat Elect [1]	407.60	406.20	409.15	411.00	404.05	10893.64	473.25	361.05	49	406.05
Bharat Forge [2]	2100.50	2130.60	2102.00	2140.20	2085.40	585.56	2236.95	1100.50	88	2130.35
Bharat Wire	208.14	215.62	210.99	219.00	208.02	232.39	262.20	149.15	20	215.55
BharatCoking	36.70	37.25	36.93	37.61	36.88	10371.08	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	229.69	245.09	229.00	259.00	229.00	3244.78	259.00	101.00	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1888.10	1931.10	1902.00	1966.00	1898.80	11145.07	2174.70	1745.00	75	1930.50
Bharti Hexa	1519.90	1571.50	1526.00	1605.80	1500.40	433.14	1955.60	1430.00	-	-
BHEL [2]	377.80	381.60	380.00	387.00	379.30	9102.80	424.85	205.20	84	381.55
Bikaji Fds	643.95	642.15	643.95	648.80	638.15	64.37	818.70	592.55	-	-
Billionbrain	191.84	198.44	193.00	198.90	192.79	22339.79	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	397.05	403.55	399.80	409.60	394.85	5590.15	440.30	331.00	276	403.65
BIRLA CORPN.	936.40	940.70	932.70	953.45	932.30	118.28	1537.15	773.90	25	941.50
Birlanu Ltd	1336.50	1331.70	1336.80	1363.80	1307.00	13.62	2425.00	1190.10	-	-
Birlasoft	272.20	274.85	274.90	276.25	270.20	1756.53	474.00	270.20	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	240.45	244.60	240.65	246.20	240.15	10797.79	325.55	231.00	6	244.55
Bk of India	135.12	138.53	135.60	139.23	135.44	8302.82	178.45	109.00	6	138.65
BL kashyap [1]	52.98	52.73	53.32	53.68	52.12	438.03	80.07	40.79	26	52.37
Black Box	931.70	934.25	939.65	959.00	928.10	199.48	1103.00	435.05	-	-
BLS [1]	242.70	234.60	244.00	245.30	231.75	9439.90	415.00	218.45	94	234.85
BLS e-Svc	261.40	261.35	262.95	267.80	258.26	303.61	285.90	124.30	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	562.70	574.50	568.00	587.00	564.20	546.53	1027.80	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1574.80	1615.60	1588.00	1620.90	1584.00	254.12	2049.95	1450.00	80	1614.40
BlueDart Exp	4789.40	4846.80	4793.00	4892.90	4793.00	3.86	7030.15	4630.50	42	4846.65
BluestoneJew	566.20	571.75	566.65	581.40	565.00	182.13	793.00	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	105.61	106.66	107.00	111.00	105.51	677.25	131.82	43.98	-	-
Bom Dyeing [2]	123.91	126.08	124.10	127.40	124.10	374.11	196.50	92.10	94	126.15
BombayBur [2]	1498.10	1513.40	1500.40	1530.40	1488.00	50.44	2135.00	1301.00	141	1510.55
Borosil	227.31	230.88	228.44	235.00	228.10	71.21	397.95	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	594.60	651.65	602.00	659.50	598.60	5819.74	721.00	374.40	-	-
Borosil.Sci.	155.84	158.31	156.70	161.57	155.23	86.55	190.79	96.64	-	-
Bosch Home	1339.40	1347.80	1340.00	1369.00	1340.00	28.34	1845.00	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	41610.00	42225.00	41610.00	42320.00	41610.00	25.17	42549.95	28650.05	53	42251.35
BPCL	303.55	308.20	303.55	309.10	299.75	5543.01	391.85	266.55	5	308.25
BPL	53.34	58.84	54.10	64.00	53.70	935.76	91.99	38.00	-	59.23
BrainbeesSol	206.65	203.44	207.90	209.47	202.56	1966.58	438.70	202.56	-	-
Brigade	502.75	534.00	502.75	537.15	500.00	2343.25	856.35	461.25	62	533.05
BrigadeHotel	62.84	63.54	63.49	64.10	63.00	78.01	91.77	54.36	-	-
BrightcomGr [2]	9.48	9.42	9.48	9.68	9.40	3585.83	21.65	7.71	-	9.43
Britannia [1]	5315.50	5361.50	5326.00	5388.50	5326.00	174.11	6336.95	5038.00	50	5362.15
BSE Ltd	3739.10	3805.70	3762.00	3852.00	3760.60	2319.84	4446.80	2021.50	-	-

C

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE CI
Camlin Fine [1]	129.05	129.29	128.70	132.72	128.70	587.74	311.90	96.30	-	129.20
Campus Act.	229.89	228.04	227.80	229.85	226.30	214.06	304.40	215.20	-	-
CAMS	749.80	775.70	749.50	779.60	747.00	1310.92	4289.00	611.40	-	-
Canara Bank [2]	121.15	124.80	121.77	125.30	121.50	25763.23	162.90	103.50	6	124.80
Canara HSBCL	141.89	141.34	141.95	143.46	140.50	436.54	159.00	106.00	-	-
Canara RobAM	243.61	253.99	244.50	255.60	243.11	347.77	353.40	214.20	-	-
Canfin Hom [2]	892.30	916.10	892.90	920.80	892.90	258.93	970.00	709.05	11	915.05
Cantabil [2]	251.84	252.71	253.00	256.29	251.46	36.79	321.50	208.05	22	253.05
CAPACITE	234.70	234.80	236.85	241.40	233.10	372.53	338.50	178.90	12	234.55
CapillaryTec	510.65	506.60	509.55	514.20	500.30	58.06	798.95	464.25	-	-
CAPLIN PO [2]	2528.40	2621.40	2553.60	2638.00	2550.00	119.27	2680.00	1502.45	50	2620.40
Carborun [1]	1080.50	1089.80	1082.60	1096.90	1072.10	303.05	1306.40	734.65	50	1090.00
Care Rating	1610.10	1639.10	1618.10	1648.10	1599.10	19.36	1885.10	1393.95	28	1638.20
Carraro Ind	524.50	561.00	544.80	579.80	543.60	1185.57	667.55	405.00	-	-
Cartrade Tch	2775.90	2735.20	2775.90	2823.60	2692.00	435.11	3290.50	1600.00	-	-
Carysil	1098.50	1186.60	1106.50	1194.00	1105.90	130.24	1247.90	732.10	-	-
CASTROL [5]	183.31	183.50	183.11	184.00	183.11	867.57	232.40	170.20	19	183.60
CCCL [2]	15.48	16.49	15.71	17.00	15.42	400.00	28.90	12.80	-	16.37
CCL PRODU [2]	1181.20	1209.20	1182.00	1223.90	1182.00	355.16	1236.00	809.35	56	1208.45
CDSL	1311.40	1346.50	1316.00	1354.60	1316.00	1462.20	1794.90	1116.30	-	-

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CHENNAI
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FRIDAY - JULY 10 - 2026

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Pine Labs	142.07	143.29	142.84	145.75	141.59	6758.83	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	2124.50	2118.20	2130.00	2150.10	2100.00	187.39	2220.00	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	168.11	171.99	168.10	175.95	166.25	7859.69	220.85	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	924.20	951.45	933.80	954.10	923.15	23.47	1069.85	677.20	37	949.70
Pix Transm	1741.00	1782.30	1728.60	1821.90	1728.60	24.31	1930.00	1220.10	-	-
PlatinumInd	228.49	226.99	233.10	234.00	224.21	91.99	342.40	183.50	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	573.50	581.30	576.90	606.30	573.00	900.03	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	85.84	87.33	85.97	88.50	85.42	366.45	119.84	58.75	9	87.45
PNB Housng	1072.20	1084.00	1076.60	1095.50	1051.60	829.95	1116.40	730.00	12	1084.85
PNC Infra [2]	238.18	241.53	235.92	242.24	235.85	346.04	331.80	157.95	18	241.20
PNGS Reva Di	403.10	414.20	409.00	428.00	405.00	297.56	476.75	324.25	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	992.80	1035.40	1000.50	1060.00	995.00	75.00	1147.35	692.55	-	1032.40
Poly Medicu [5]	1614.30	1645.90	1618.90	1686.00	1618.00	56.98	2238.40	1184.00	49	1646.60
Polycab Ind.	9234.00	9074.00	9280.00	9329.00	9001.00	487.54	10126.00	6605.00	-	-
Polyplex	1019.15	1029.45	1024.00	1042.00	1011.10	96.28	1190.35	743.00	55	1028.20
PonawallaFin	457.95	463.85	458.60	469.40	458.60	2036.54	570.40	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	1461.60	1416.60	1478.00	1530.10	1410.00	663.83	1619.00	898.70	-	-
Power Finan	403.60	404.10	403.55	406.25	399.00	6397.78	486.45	330.05	7	403.90
Power grid	279.70	281.35	280.00	283.95	280.00	6800.58	324.80	250.05	16	281.15
Power Trad	168.42	168.02	169.40	169.99	167.69	637.49	229.40	149.90	12	168.00
Powerica Ltd	542.70	567.80	548.50	569.80	545.00	281.94	676.95	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2562.60	2604.20	2573.20	2624.50	2573.20	35.15	3415.45	1718.00	28	2605.05
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	355.15	353.95	356.90	360.85	352.75	464.40	512.00	273.05	47	354.00
Prajay Eng	19.75	19.37	20.00	20.03	19.22	39.62	33.80	17.26	-	19.45
Prakash Ind.	126.31	128.22	127.93	129.39	126.11	338.72	191.00	110.00	7	128.15
PRAVEG.	226.77	234.31	227.09	239.40	227.09	49.04	325.00	210.40	-	-
Precam	144.69	146.12	145.89	147.70	145.00	95.51	263.30	104.05	41	146.00
PRECISION	257.43	276.63	269.00	292.90	269.00	674.94	295.35	177.05	51	276.20
Precision Wr [1]	374.90	389.25	379.95	391.50	379.95	219.59	467.10	166.90	46	389.85
Premier Enr	1043.90	1089.20	1055.00	1095.50	1048.00	1970.05	1136.40	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	685.40	714.00	692.00	739.00	681.50	1477.02	829.95	378.80	77	714.75
prestige Est	1635.30	1673.90	1628.00	1683.20	1628.00	742.65	1812.40	1090.45	394	1675.45

Exchange Traded Funds

Company	Pr Cl	NSE Cl	Vol	52 WH	52 WL	BSE Cl
MIRAEAMC - VALUE	15.84	16.00	18.95	19.69	14.83	-
MIRAEAMC-ALPHAETF	25.65	26.07	445.82	27.00	21.80	-
MIRAEAMC-BANKETF	577.90	583.68	14.98	628.27	507.01	-
MIRAEAMC-ITETF	29.10	29.08	581.38	42.02	27.22	-
MIRAEAMC-LIQUID	999.99	999.99	393.77	1024.98	994.99	-
MIRAEAMC-MAESGETF	41.07	41.16	50.44	45.06	37.52	-
MIRAEAMC-MAFANG	193.17	194.06	93.01	208.38	147.44	-
MIRAEAMC-MAFSETF	27.33	27.53	298.36	29.94	24.03	-
MIRAEAMC-MAGOLDETF	137.65	139.08	783.07	173.50	94.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MAM150ETF	23.02	23.35	1733.59	24.00	19.60	-
MIRAEAMC-MAMFGETF	159.91	160.23	17.56	167.77	120.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MAN50ETF	259.36	260.20	303.32	289.05	239.81	-
MIRAEAMC-MANV30F	203.85	204.86	0.00	219.10	183.58	-
MIRAEAMC-MANXT50	731.10	737.64	39.57	753.43	617.00	-
MIRAEAMC-MASPTOP50	78.74	78.33	194.94	82.78	55.52	-
MIRAEAMC-SENSEXETF	78.90	79.09	105.01	88.70	73.33	-
MotiAMCMOCap	53.54	54.83	701.84	57.25	41.15	-
MOTIAMC-MOHEALTH	49.83	50.51	89.59	51.77	40.79	-
MOTIAMC-MOLOWVOL	36.93	36.94	2.53	43.07	33.52	-
MOTIAMC-MOMOMEN	60.82	61.30	29.92	66.28	54.32	-
MOTILALAMC - MOTOUR	78.94	80.15	38.12	97.20	64.00	-
MOTILALAMC-G5	65.23	65.21	6.46	66.49	60.18	-
MOTILALAMC-MONIFTY500	23.44	23.71	702.04	24.88	20.75	-
MOTILALAMC-MOQUALITY	198.30	201.22	0.10	225.60	176.15	-
MOTILALAMC-MOVALUE	112.11	113.06	463.08	128.77	98.10	-
MotilAMCMODe	102.68	102.35	1048.86	107.99	77.80	-
MOTIOSMIDCAP100ETF	66.13	67.06	323.92	69.20	56.15	-
MOTIOSNASDAQ100ETF	324.70	324.85	330.52	342.55	189.75	-
MOTIOSWALM50ETF	249.60	251.86	3.74	279.33	231.11	-
NiftyBeEs [1]	271.69	272.76	7079.31	298.77	251.16	272.59
NiftyJrBeEs [1]	765.88	771.82	376.07	797.81	648.00	771.44
NipIndETDivO	75.45	75.67	34.36	87.09	72.13	-
NipIndETFCon	129.20	129.97	76.24	144.38	114.00	-
NIPINDETFETFNV20	139.54	139.66	540.06	160.00	122.02	-
NIPINDETFIT	30.51	30.45	14662.50	44.27	28.55	-
NIPINDETFLONGTEGILT	29.85	29.94	968.02	30.35	27.93	-
Zerod Mid150	11.33	11.45	934.89	13.00	9.63	-
Zerod Top100	10.45	10.47	516.98	11.57	9.48	-
ZerodAMC-Liq	114.89	114.91	13656.64	114.92	102.00	-
ZerodAMSML10	10.65	10.84	1545.61	11.74	8.50	-
ZerodhaA-Gol	22.28	22.51	14991.06	27.94	15.01	-
ZerodhAMCGil	30.43	30.52	131.96	31.17	28.71	-
ZerodhAMCSil	22.25	22.55	12334.75	38.01	10.52	-
ZerodhAM-Nif	9.57	9.59	488.53	10.97	8.84	-

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Standard Engin	265.80	276.00
Star H&A Ins	583.75	602.90
Std.Cap.Mrkt [1]	0.44	0.42
Steel Exch [1]	11.98	12.14
Stove Kraft	782.95	798.65
Sula Vine [2]	148.30	149.65
Sumitomo Ch	467.10	480.70
Supra Pac.Fi	32.79	32.75
Supriya Life [2]	862.80	875.35
Suven Phar [1]	431.30	440.60
SW Pinnacle	228.75	230.15

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Timex Group [1]	522.40	546.55
Tinna Rubber	905.55	955.50
Titan Biotec [2]	397.40	390.70
Titan Int [1]	0.96	0.95
TMB	751.45	767.85
Transrail Li [2]	486.70	505.70
Tube Invt [1]	2900.60	2916.00
Turtlemint Fin	128.75	130.35
TVS Supply [1]	134.85	141.55
Unimech Aer[5]	1162.85	1209.80
Uniparts Ind	642.25	680.75

Company	Pr Cl	Cl
Vikram Solar L	183.80	193.40
Vikran Eng [1]	72.72	73.49
Vintage Coff.	155.10	163.30
Virtuoso Op	448.85	437.40
VishalMega	115.90	116.70
Waaree Enr	2823.05	2862.50
Waaree Re. [2]	977.20	987.65
Wardwiz.Inn [1]	6.78	6.75
Waterways Leis	825.75	859.40
Welcure D [1]	0.25	0.26
Wework India M	713.80	719.60

NSE Trade for Trade